

Union Square Big Wigs

The Crossroads of a Nation: A Chronicle of Union Square

Every previously italicized phrase is highlighted and colour-coded by source. Where the source page is on file, clicking the highlight opens the scan.

COLOUR KEY — ONE COLOUR PER SOURCE · sources with a page scan are marked ↗

- | | |
|---|---|
| ■ Kayton, <i>Radical Walking Tours of New York City</i> , 1999 p. 80 (13) ↗ | ■ Wolfe, <i>New York 15 Walking Tours</i> , 2003 pp. 227, 252 (3) ↗ |
| ■ Leadon, <i>Broadway A History of New York in Thirteen Miles</i> , 2018 pp. 112, 118, 129 (18) ↗ | ■ Morgan, <i>The Civil War Lover's Guide to New York City</i> , 2013 p. 68 (18) ↗ |
| ■ Jenkins, <i>The Greatest Street in the World</i> , 1911 pp. 225-226 (3) ↗ | ■ Grafton, <i>New York in the Nineteenth Century</i> , 1977 pp. 18, 23 (4) ↗ |
| ■ Strausbaugh, <i>City of Sedition</i> , 2016 p. 293 (3) ↗ | ■ Swandiak, <i>The 500 Hidden Secrets of New York</i> , 2017 p. 162 (2) ↗ |
| ■ Lightfoot, <i>Nineteenth Century in Rare Photographs</i> , 1981 p. 68 (2) ↗ | ■ Bergman, <i>The Spiritual Traveler New York City</i> , 2001 p. 133 (2) ↗ |
| ■ Whalen, <i>Mr New York</i> , 1955 p. 155 (7) ↗ | ■ Plumb, <i>Notable New York The East Side</i> , 2006 pp. 226, 231 (11) ↗ |
| ■ Kiedrowski, <i>Andy Warhols New York</i> , 2011 pp. 93, 97 (4) ↗ | ■ King, <i>King's Handbook of New York City</i> , 1892 p. 689 (2) ↗ |
| ■ AIA, <i>AIA Guide to New York City Edition 3</i> , 1988 p. 185 (1) ↗ | ■ Ferrara, <i>A Guide to Gangsters</i> , 2009 p. 181 (2) ↗ |
| ■ Wilson, <i>New York in Literature</i> , 1947 p. 128 (2) ↗ | |

AUDIO — UNION SQUARE BIG WIGS | BRICK CAKE 29 min 00 s

Audio track — playable in the HTML version of this document.

I. FROM COMMON GROUND TO COVETED ADDRESS

Every great civic space begins as something humbler, and this one was no exception. In its earliest incarnation the land offered nothing of distinction — *(Prior to this, it held squatters and a potter's field.)* Its eventual name has long invited misunderstanding, though its true derivation is prosaic rather than patriotic: *(Named for the union of Broadway and Fourth Avenue (not the large number of union headquarters historically in the area), Union Square was completed in 1835 as one of several squares set up in Manhattan.)* A second chronicler sharpens the point and dispels the persistent myths altogether: *(The name "Union" derives not from Civil War days, nor from any association with the labor unions whose activities were later identified with the square, but merely from the fact that this was the "place of union" of the Bowery Road with the northbound Bloomingdale Road.)*

What followed was a swift and dramatic ascent in fortune. As speculation took hold, *(In the 1840s, the rich bought up the area and lots around the square began selling for ten times their original \$500 value.)* One by one, the titans of trade raised their houses along the green. Foremost among them was a merchant of glass — *(Cornelius van Schaack Roosevelt, an importer of plate glass, lived in a large house at the corner of Broadway and 14th Street, facing the southern edge of the square.)* He was soon joined by neighbors of comparable means, for nearby *(James F. Penniman, a manufacturer of linseed oil, built a fabulously appointed brownstone mansion at 42 East 14th Street, just west of Roosevelt.)* More opulent still was the home of a silk importer, where *(Henry Parish, an importer of silk, built an opulent mansion, stuffed with Old Master paintings and featuring an oval stair ascending to a central dome, with an attached conservatory in the side yard, at the southwest corner of Broadway and 17th Street.)* The most eccentric residence of all belonged to a pair of brothers, for *(Robert Goelet, heir to a family fortune made in hardware, lived directly across 17th Street from Parish, while, two blocks to the north, Goelet's brother Peter built a mysterious brick house set back from the street on one-third of an acre of lawn stocked with strutting peacocks.)*

II. THE HOUR OF UNION: APRIL 1861

When the guns of Sumter shattered the peace, the square answered with a roar that would echo through the century. In the war's opening days, *(On April 20, 1861, a mass rally held here supported Lincoln's call for 75,000 volunteers.)* The magnitude of the assembly strained belief — *(A crowd estimated at 100,000 to 250,000 people turned out to listen to the 20 dignitaries scheduled to speak that day.)* Presiding over this ocean of humanity stood the establishment of the city itself, for *(The meeting was presided over by John A. Dix with eighty-seven vice-presidents from the leading men of the community),* a roster so illustrious that *(The list began with Peter Cooper and ended with John J. Astor.)*

Among the voices that rose that afternoon, one carried a tragic prophecy in its wake, for *(The most famous of the orators who addressed the meeting was Senator Baker of Oregon, who, during the Mexican War, had led a New York regiment to the gates of the city of Mexico, and who, a few months later, was to give his life for the Union upon the disastrous field of Ball's Bluff, on the soil of the Old Dominion.)*

Yet the true emotional summit of the day belonged not to a speaker but to a soldier. All eyes turned to a single weary figure, for *(The highlight was the appearance of the Union officer who had been in command of Fort Sumter, Maj. Robert Anderson (1805-1871).)* His arrival was still fresh in memory — *(Following his surrender on April 13, 1861, he and his men had been allowed to return north aboard the Baltic, arriving in New York harbor on April 19.)* His fidelity was all the more moving for the circumstances of his birth, since *(Although a Southerner by birth and pro-slavery himself, Anderson remained loyal to the Union. He was promoted to brigadier general and became the North's first national hero.)* In symbolic tribute, *(The flag that had flown over Fort Sumter was draped over the equestrian statue of George Washington at the south end of*

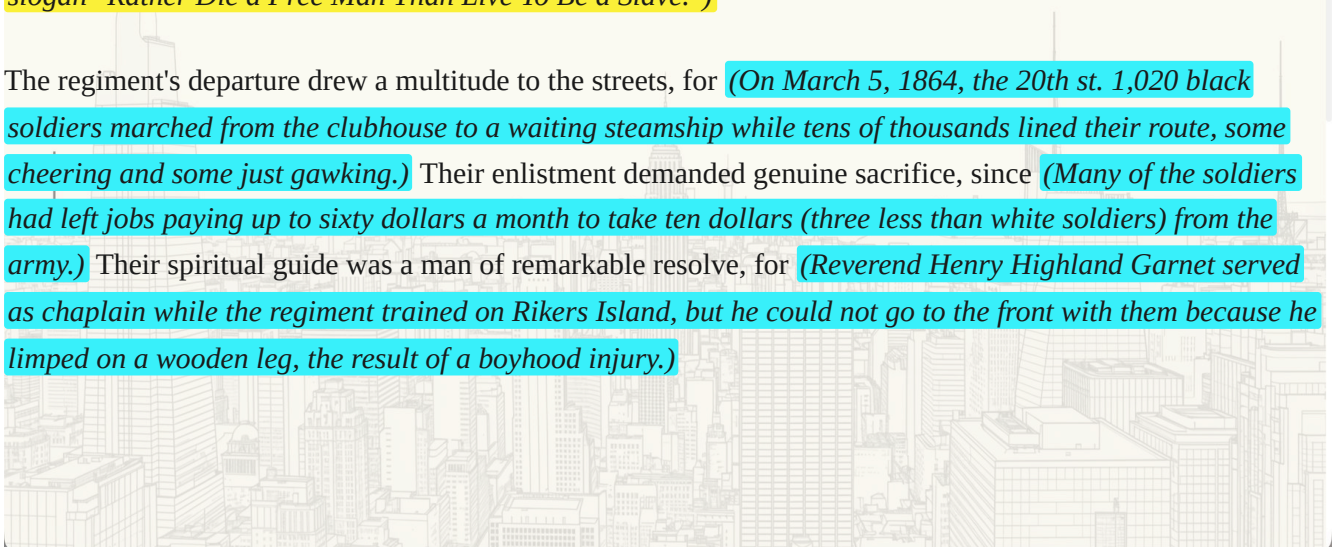
the square.) No one present would forget the spectacle, for *(The crowd that wildly cheered Anderson that day was the largest ever assembled in the country, and the New York Tribune reprinted it as "the greatest popular demonstration ever known in America.")*

III. CHARITY AND VALOR AMID THE CONFLICT

As the war ground on, the square became a theater of both benevolence and quiet heroism. Its women mounted an extraordinary campaign of relief, for *(Also in 1864, the women of the Sanitary Commission hosted a giant charity bazaar called the Metropolitan Sanitary Fair in the square, and in only three weeks raised somewhere between \$500,000- \$1,000,000 for medical supplies for the troops.)* The undertaking sprawled across the district, since *(The buildings, erected especially for the occasion, stood on Union Square and along West 14th Street.)* At its command stood men whose names still resonate, for *(Frederick Law Olmsted, designer of Central Park, served as its general secretary; Henry W. Bellows, pastor of All Souls Unitarian Church, was its president.)* One devoted participant would leave posterity an incomparable record, since *(One tireless worker for the Commission throughout the war was New York lawyer George Templeton Strong, whose lengthy and readable diary, discovered and published only in the middle of the twentieth century, is one of the major sources for details of New York life in the middle of the nineteenth century, especially during the war years.)*

That same year witnessed a scene of profound historical weight. In an act of defiance against prevailing prejudice, *(It was also in Union Square on March 5, 1864, that the Union League Club presented the colors to the North's first black regiment, the 20th U.S. Colored Troops.)* The moment carried a bitter irony, for *(Oddly enough, during the early years of the war the South used the services of black men but the North did not.)* The correction came from private conviction rather than official policy, as *(Eventually a group of white citizens, many members of the Union League Club, formed the New York Association for Colored Volunteers and outfitted them.)* Their banner proclaimed an unbending creed, for *(Their standard was emblazoned with the slogan "Rather Die a Free Man Than Live To Be a Slave.")*

The regiment's departure drew a multitude to the streets, for *(On March 5, 1864, the 20th st. 1,020 black soldiers marched from the clubhouse to a waiting steamship while tens of thousands lined their route, some cheering and some just gawking.)* Their enlistment demanded genuine sacrifice, since *(Many of the soldiers had left jobs paying up to sixty dollars a month to take ten dollars (three less than white soldiers) from the army.)* Their spiritual guide was a man of remarkable resolve, for *(Reverend Henry Highland Garnet served as chaplain while the regiment trained on Rikers Island, but he could not go to the front with them because he limped on a wooden leg, the result of a boyhood injury.)*



IV. A CITY IN MOURNING

When the nation's leader fell to an assassin, the square that had cheered his war now grieved his passing. In solemn communion, *(On April 25, 1865, following Lincoln's death, a massive ecumenical outdoor service was held in the square for the assassinated president.)* Clergy of every tradition stood shoulder to shoulder, as *(Archbishop John McCloskey, Rabbi Samuel Isaacs, and Reverend Stephen Tyng led the worshippers.)* With that gathering an era drew to its close, for *(This was the last grand rally of the Civil War era.)*

A future president witnessed the sorrow from a nursery window, for it was recorded that *(It was from a window on the second floor of that house that six-year-old Theodore Roosevelt, Cornelius's grandson, watched Abraham Lincoln's funeral procession pass slowly down Broadway in 1865.)*

V. GRIEF CAST IN BRONZE

Out of mourning arose enduring memorials. The city's grief soon sought permanent form, for *(Soon after the death of Lincoln, the Union League Club commissioned sculptor Henry Kirke Brown (1814-1886) to create a monument in honor of the slain president.)* The work claimed a distinction all its own, since *(When this memorial was dedicated in Union Square on September 16, 1870, it became the first outdoor statue of Lincoln in America.)* Its original ornament has long since vanished, for *(Originally the statue was surrounded by a fence that bore an inscription of Lincoln's famous words, "With malice toward none; with charity toward all," but the fence disappeared some unknown time later.)* Nor did the artist's design escape reproach, as *(Controversy erupted when the statue was unveiled, due to the fact that Lincoln wore a toga over his suit.)*

Its companion in bronze had presided over the square for more than a decade already, for *(Henry Kirke Brown's masterful equestrian statue of Washington, one of the earliest pieces of civic sculpture in the city, was unveiled in 1856.)* The monument even served an unlikely purpose in its early years, since *(A "slave market" for unemployed actors met near the statue in summer, waiting for possible employers.)* Its place in the square was not permanent, however, for *(At the end of the century the statue was moved to its present location in the center of the square's park.)*

A third figure arrived as a gesture of transatlantic gratitude, for *(The statue was designed by Frederic-Auguste Bartholdi (who also designed the Statue of Liberty) and is a token of appreciation from the French government for aid provided during the Franco-Prussian War.)* That very commission opened the door to his greatest triumph, since *(This statue helped Bartholdi win the commission for the Statue of Liberty a few years later.)*

A century on, a fourth monument joined the assembly of heroes, for *(A statue of Mohandas Gandhi (1869-1948) by Kantilal Patel (1986) stands in the pedestrian triangle at the southwest corner of Union Square.)* Its placement was no accident, since *(The Parks Department chose this site because of Union Square's tradition*

of public protests.)

VI. THE NATION'S HUNDREDTH BIRTHDAY

The centennial of the Republic found its stage upon this ground. Years earlier the space had been entrusted to the age's finest hands, for *(In 1872 the city hired Calvert Vaux and Frederick Law Olmsted, designers of Central Park, to remake Union Square according to a more up-to-date, picturesque aesthetic.)* When the great night arrived, the square could scarcely contain the throng, since *(an estimated crowd of 40,000 to 50,000 squeezed into Union Square to await the midnight commencement of the Fourth of July and the nation's Centennial.)* The music was as exuberant as it was disorderly, for *(The numerous brass bands that had marched in the parade were somehow combined into one group, forming an ungainly orchestra of 600 instruments that managed to play together, more or less, "The Star-Spangled Banner," "Hail the Atlantis," and Beethoven's "The Heavens Are Telling the Glory of God," accompanied by a chorus of 600 singers.)* Exuberance soon spilled into peril, for *(At the stroke of midnight, fireworks rocketed skyward from each corner of the park. Hats were thrown in the air and pistols fired (at least nine people were accidentally shot).)* A venerable poet lent his verse to the occasion, since *(Poet William Cullen Bryant, eighty-one, contributed a special "Centennial Ode.")*

VII. THE FORGE OF AMERICAN DISSENT

As the century turned, the square assumed a new and combustible identity as the crucible of the nation's labor movement. It hosted a milestone that would reshape the calendar, for *(In 1882, the first official labor day parade in the country took place here with nearly twenty-five thousand workers marching in demand of the eight-hour day, an end to both child labor and the contract system.)* Its architects harbored ambitions far beyond the eight-hour day, since *(The organizers, the Central Labor Union, urged workers to sever all ties to the Democratic and Republican Parties, and unite worldwide.)*

The garment trades left their imprint here as well, for *(In 1910, the ILGWU organized a rally of five thousand here, during the "Uprising of the Twenty Thousand.")* Tragedy soon lent the movement its martyrs, since *(The following year, a funeral procession for the victims of the Triangle Shirtwaist Factory Fire marched from Washington Square to Union Square.)*

At times the fervor turned to bloodshed. In one calamitous episode, *(On March 28, 1908, at a rally of the Socialist Conference of the Unemployed, twenty-two-year-old anarchist Selig Silverstein attempted to throw a homemade bomb at the police after they had clubbed demonstrators.)* The design recoiled fatally upon its

maker, for *(The bomb exploded in Silverstein's hands, killing him and a passerby but leaving the police unharmed.)*

The massacre at Ludlow drove the radicals to open provocation. In a gesture of macabre defiance, *(Berkman, who had been released from prison eight years earlier, staged a "funeral" for the would-be bombers in Union Square.)* The platform drew the leading lights of American radicalism, for *(Speakers, including anarchists Rebecca Edelsohn and Charles Plunkett and Wobblies Carlo Tresca and Elizabeth Gurley Flynn, held forth under the watchful eyes of Chief Inspector Max F. Schmittberger and a force of 1,000 police armed with clubs.)* One orator issued her creed without apology, for *("I want to say it's about time the working class came out frankly and openly and said 'Yes, we believe in violence,'" Edelsohn, wearing a black dress and red stockings, told the crowd.)* Another pressed the argument to its extremity, declaring that *("[i] am for violence," Charles Plunkett shouted. "Not only defensive violence, but offensive violence. I don't believe in waiting until we are attacked.")* The seasoned policeman met such fury with dry composure, since *("That was pretty hot stuff," Schmittberger, a Broadway Squad veteran, remarked when Berkman finished.)*

The same firebrand returned to name the guilty a second time, for *(Carlo Tresca spoke on International Worker's Day in 1914, denouncing those who killed thirty-three workers in the Ludlow, Colorado strike at the Rockefeller-owned Colorado Fuel and Iron Company.)* His indictment reached its theatrical climax when *("Name the Murderer!" he thundered and the crowd called back "Rockefeller!")*

An earlier agitator had already paid dearly for her eloquence, for *(In 1893, Emma Goldman was arrested for a speech to the unemployed, wherein she urged those without bread to take it.)* Her confinement proved unexpectedly formative, since *(She spent a year in jail at Blackwell's Island (now Roosevelt Island), learning the nursing trade; she later earned two medical degrees in Europe.)*

VIII. THE HIGH-WATER MARK OF THE RED TIDE

The Depression summoned to the square a gathering of unprecedented scale. It was born of a nationwide call, for *(One of the most famous demonstrations in Union Square was in 1930, when, during the depression, the Communist Party called for nation-wide demonstrations against unemployment.)* The city's police commissioner recalled its genesis with precision, noting that *(Early in March of 1930 we received a report from our Police Intelligence Squad that 100,000 postal cards had been sent out to members of the Communist Party summoning them to a meeting to be held March 6 at noon in Union Square.)* His summons to the movement's leaders met with flat rejection, for *(I was told by my three guests that they did not respect the laws of the United States and the State of New York, or the ordinances of the City of New York, and that they would*

not make any application for a permit to hold a meeting in Union Square.) The multitude that assembled dwarfed all precedent, since (Over 100,000 people had congregated around Union Square by noon. It was one of the largest crowds ever seen there and was the high-water mark in Red demonstrations.)

A symbolic affront flared briefly before the authorities intervened, for (When the committee went back to the crowd it was as if by magic that six portable stands were put up for the speakers and the Soviet flag run up over the American flag.) The response came at once, since (The police immediately corrected this error and ordered that the flags be reversed before any speakers could address the audience.) The rhetoric of the day fell chiefly upon the commissioner himself, for (Most of the oratory was addressed against "Whalen's Cossacks" and their brutality.) When the crowd sought to march, it found every avenue sealed, since (The police cut off movement to the south entirely, so in the end the demonstrators never got below 14th Street.)

A generation later, one final protest brushed the square's edges, for (On June 19, 1953, since the police refused to let organizers use Union Square, several thousand crowded Seventeenth Street adjoining the square to protest the impending execution of the Rosenbergs.)

IX. THE SILVER PROPHET OF UNION SQUARE

In the century's latter half, the square drew a legend of an altogether different order. Abandoning uptown for the district's bohemian energy, (Artist Andy Warhol moved to the fifth floor of this twelve-story building in 1968.) His new sanctum bore a name that would become synonymous with the age, since (The white-walled loft space was called *The Factory* and housed studios, his office, and a screening room for his films.) The building's history proved curiously fitting, for (The eleven-story Decker Building on Union Square was designed by John Edelmann, an architect known to have anarchist sympathies, for the Decker Piano Co.) Its guardianship was famously whimsical, since (A stuffed Great Dane (which Warhol hinted had belonged to Cecil B. DeMille—though the staff could never match it to any photos of DeMille's dogs) stood next to the entrance as their lone security measure.)

Then came the day that nearly ended everything, for (On June 3, 1968, Valerie Solanas, an occasional *Factory* visitor and sole member of SCUM (Society for Cutting Up Men), came to Warhol's office here, pulled a revolver and shot point blank at him, hitting the artist in the chest.) Against every expectation he clung to life, since (Warhol was pronounced dead at the hospital but, miraculously, managed to survive.) The reckoning that followed was swift yet lenient, for (The crazed Solanas surrendered to the police a few hours after the shooting. She served a three-year sentence and died in 1988. Warhol lived until 1987.)

Outgrowing his quarters, the artist relocated only steps away, for (By 1974, Warhol had run out of space at his Union Square studio called *The Factory* and, in August of that year, he moved across the street to this six-story brick building.) Ever the pragmatist, he transformed the move into a ritual, since (Always economical, Warhol

made it a condition that all visitors to The Factory during the move had to carry at least one item across the street to the new building.) From the disorder of relocation sprang an enduring artwork, for (One of the first was accidental: Warhol's Time Capsules.) In these rooms he embraced the coming generation, since (He reenergized his image by producing artwork with younger artists of the time, notably Keith Haring, Jean-Michel Basquiat, and Francesco Clemente.)

X. THE SOLITARY MASTER

Decades before Warhol's arrival, another painter labored in obscurity along the square's eastern flank. In a quiet devotion to his craft, (Painter Arshile Gorky worked on his art in a studio on this site from 1929 until his death in 1948.) His journey to New York had begun far from these streets, for (Gorky was an Armenian born in Turkey who came to New York in 1925.) He regarded his workplace with near-religious reverence, since (Gorky treated his working space here as a sacred area—he scrubbed the floor weekly, stocked it with the best materials, and hung life-size photographs of his favorite masters on the wall.) His story ended in sorrow, for (Gorky committed suicide by hanging in Connecticut on July 21, 1948 at the age of forty-eight.)

XI. MERCHANTS, MONEY, AND A GANGSTER'S LAST STAND

The commercial spirit reshaped the square with equal drama. In a single stroke of demolition and construction, (IN 1870, TIFFANY'S DEMOLISHED the James Renwick-designed Church of the Puritans on the west side of Union Square and replaced it with a huge cast-iron store—the "Palace of Jewels.") The booksellers followed, chief among them a man of humble beginnings, for (It is interesting to note that Agosto Brentano, who came to America as a poor cripple from Sicily, eked out a living selling newspapers and periodicals, and ultimately became the most famous book dealer in the country.)

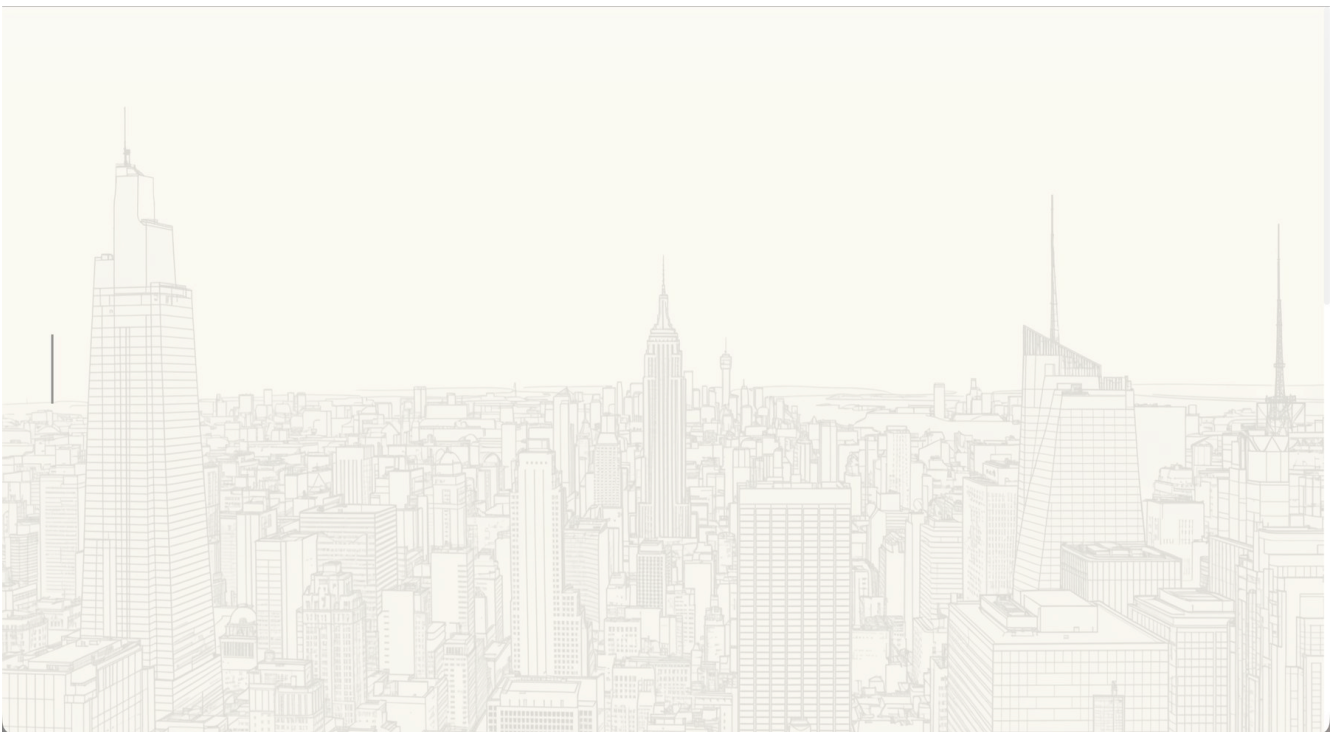
Finance planted its roots here as well, for (The bank was organized in 1871, and commenced operations in June of that year.) Its governing board read like a directory of the age's commercial aristocracy, since its members numbered (Charles L. Tiffany, of Tiffany & Company; Hon. Samuel Sloan, President of the Delaware, Lackawanna & Western Railroad; Robert Schell, the President; Joseph Park, of Park & Tilford; William Steinway, of Steinway & Sons; William B. Isham, capitalist; W. D. Sloane, of W. & J. Sloane; and Hicks Arnold, of Arnold, Constable & Company.) Close at hand, a hotel became the deathbed of a celebrated thinker, for (The single-tax economist Henry George died here on October 29, 1897.)

And on Fourteenth Street a notorious criminal met his violent end. Having sought redemption after the Great War, (By 1920, former gang leader Monk Eastman was trying to lead a life along the straight and narrow.) Yet his reform could not spare him, since (So, he got involved with a crooked Prohibition agent, who on December

26 of that year shot and killed Eastman in a drunken dispute on the sidewalk outside this address.)

XII. LITERARY SHADES OF THE SIDE STREETS

The quieter blocks flanking the square harbored their own distinguished ghosts. Among them, a scion of old New York breathed his last, for *(That sturdy descendant of the Knickerbockers, Gulian C. Verplanck, died at 12 East Sixteenth Street.)* Another author lodged nearby and, in a letter home, captured the wry contentment of old age, confiding that *("I see a great deal of Mark Twain nowadays," he wrote his sister from this address, "and we have good times denouncing even thing. We are old fellows, and it is pleasant to find the world so much worse than it was when we were young.")*



CITATION CHART

Every highlighted quote, in order of appearance, correlated to its underlying source. The swatch matches the highlight colour in the text.

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
1	"Prior to this, it held squatters and a potter's field."	 Kayton, <i>Radical Walking Tours of New York City</i> , 1999, p. 80 [page scan]
2	"Named for the union of Broadway and Fourth Avenue (not the large number of union headquarters historically in the area), Union Square was completed in 1835 as one of..."	 Kayton, <i>Radical Walking Tours of New York City</i> , 1999, p. 80 [page scan]
3	"The name 'Union' derives not from Civil War days, nor from any association with the labor unions whose activities were later identified with the square, but merely from..."	 Wolfe, <i>New York 15 Walking Tours</i> , 2003, p. 227 [page scan]
4	"In the 1840s, the rich bought up the area and lots around the square began selling for ten times their original \$500 value."	 Kayton, <i>Radical Walking Tours of New York City</i> , 1999, p. 80 [page scan]
5	"Cornelius van Schaack Roosevelt, an importer of plate glass, lived in a large house at the corner of Broadway and 14th Street, facing the southern edge of the square."	 Leadon, <i>Broadway A History of New York in Thirteen Miles</i> , 2018, p. 112 [page scan]
6	"James F. Penniman, a manufacturer of linseed oil, built a fabulously appointed brownstone mansion at 42 East 14th Street, just west of Roosevelt."	 Leadon, <i>Broadway A History of New York in Thirteen Miles</i> , 2018, p. 112 [page scan]
7	"Henry Parish, an importer of silk, built an opulent mansion, stuffed with Old Master paintings and featuring an oval stair ascending to a central dome, with an attached..."	 Leadon, <i>Broadway A History of New York in Thirteen Miles</i> , 2018, p. 112 [page scan]
8	"Robert Goelet, heir to a family fortune made in hardware, lived directly across 17th Street from Parish, while, two blocks to the north, Goelet's brother Peter built a..."	 Leadon, <i>Broadway A History of New York in Thirteen Miles</i> , 2018, p. 112 [page scan]
9	"On April 20, 1861, a mass rally held here supported Lincoln's call for 75,000 volunteers."	 Morgan, <i>The Civil War Lover's Guide to New York City</i> , 2013, p. 68 [page scan]
10	"A crowd estimated at 100,000 to 250,000 people turned out to listen to the 20 dignitaries scheduled to speak that day."	 Morgan, <i>The Civil War Lover's Guide to New York City</i> , 2013, p. 68 [page scan]
11	"The meeting was presided over by John A. Dix with eighty-seven vice-presidents from the leading men of the community"	 Jenkins, <i>The Greatest Street in the World</i> , 1911, pp. 225-226 [page scan]
12	"The list began with Peter Cooper and ended with John J. Astor."	 Jenkins, <i>The Greatest Street in the World</i> , 1911, pp. 225-226 [page scan]
13	"The most famous of the orators who addressed the meeting was Senator Baker of Oregon, who, during the Mexican War, had led a New York regiment to the gates of the city..."	 Jenkins, <i>The Greatest Street in the World</i> , 1911, pp. 225-226 [page scan]
14	"The highlight was the appearance of the Union officer who had been in command of Fort Sumter, Maj. Robert Anderson (1805-1871)."	 Morgan, <i>The Civil War Lover's Guide to New York City</i> , 2013, p. 68 [page scan]

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
15	"Following his surrender on April 13, 1861, he and his men had been allowed to return north aboard the Baltic, arriving in New York harbor on April 19."	 Morgan, <i>The Civil War Lover's Guide to New York City</i> , 2013, p. 68 [page scan]
16	"Although a Southerner by birth and pro-slavery himself, Anderson remained loyal to the Union. He was promoted to brigadier general and became the North's first national..."	 Morgan, <i>The Civil War Lover's Guide to New York City</i> , 2013, p. 68 [page scan]
17	"The flag that had flown over Fort Sumter was draped over the equestrian statue of George Washington at the south end of the square."	 Morgan, <i>The Civil War Lover's Guide to New York City</i> , 2013, p. 68 [page scan]
18	"The crowd that wildly cheered Anderson that day was the largest ever assembled in the country, and the New York Tribune reponed it as "the greatest popular demonstration..."	 Morgan, <i>The Civil War Lover's Guide to New York City</i> , 2013, p. 68 [page scan]
19	"Also in 1864, the women of the Sanitary Commission hosted a giant charity bazaar called the Metropolitan Sanitary Fair in the square, and in only three weeks raised..."	 Morgan, <i>The Civil War Lover's Guide to New York City</i> , 2013, p. 68 [page scan]
20	"The buildings, erected especially for the occasion, stood on Union Square and along West 14th Street."	 Grafton, <i>New York in the Nineteenth Century</i> , 1977, p. 23 [page scan]
21	"Frederick Law Olmsted, designer of Central Park, served as its general secretary; Henry W. Bellows, pastor of All Souls Unitarian Church, was its president."	 Grafton, <i>New York in the Nineteenth Century</i> , 1977, p. 23 [page scan]
22	"One tireless worker for the Commission throughout the war was New York lawyer George Templeton Strong, whose lengthy and readable diary, discovered and published only in..."	 Grafton, <i>New York in the Nineteenth Century</i> , 1977, p. 23 [page scan]
23	"It was also in Union Square on March 5, 1864, that the Union League Club presented the colors to the North's first black regiment, the 20th U.S. Colored Troops."	 Morgan, <i>The Civil War Lover's Guide to New York City</i> , 2013, p. 68 [page scan]
24	"Oddly enough, during the early years of the war the South used the senders of black men but the North did not."	 Morgan, <i>The Civil War Lover's Guide to New York City</i> , 2013, p. 68 [page scan]
25	"Eventually a group of white citizens, many members of the Union League Club, formed the New York Association for Colored Volunteers and outfitted them."	 Morgan, <i>The Civil War Lover's Guide to New York City</i> , 2013, p. 68 [page scan]
26	"Their standard was emblazoned with the slogan "Rather Die a Free Man Than Live To Be a Slave.""	 Morgan, <i>The Civil War Lover's Guide to New York City</i> , 2013, p. 68 [page scan]
27	"On March 5, 1864, the 20th st. 1,020 black soldiers marched from the clubhouse to a waiting steamship while tens of thousands lined their route, some cheering and some..."	 Strausbaugh, <i>City of Sedition</i> , 2016, p. 293 [page scan]
28	"Many of the soldiers had left jobs paying up to sixty dollars a month to take ten dollars (three less than white soldiers) from the army."	 Strausbaugh, <i>City of Sedition</i> , 2016, p. 293 [page scan]
29	"Reverend Henry Highland Garnet served as chaplain while the regiment trained on Rikers Island, but he could not go to the front with them because he limped on a wooden..."	 Strausbaugh, <i>City of Sedition</i> , 2016, p. 293 [page scan]
30	"On April 25, 1865, following Lincoln's death, a massive ecumenical outdoor service was held in the square for the assassinated president."	 Morgan, <i>The Civil War Lover's Guide to New York City</i> , 2013, p. 68 [page scan]

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
31	"Archbishop John McCloskey, Rabbi Samuel Isaacs, and Reverend Stephen Tyng led the worshippers."	 Morgan, <i>The Civil War Lover's Guide to New York City</i> , 2013, p. 68 [page scan]
32	"This was the last grand rally of the Civil War era."	 Morgan, <i>The Civil War Lover's Guide to New York City</i> , 2013, p. 68 [page scan]
33	"It was from a window on the second floor of that house that six-year-old Theodore Roosevelt, Cornelius's grandson, watched Abraham Lincoln's funeral procession pass..."	 Leadon, <i>Broadway A History of New York in Thirteen Miles</i> , 2018, p. 112 [page scan]
34	"Soon after the death of Lincoln, the Union League Club commissioned sculptor Henry Kirke Brown (1814-1886) to create a monument in honor of the slain president."	 Morgan, <i>The Civil War Lover's Guide to New York City</i> , 2013, p. 68 [page scan]
35	"When this memorial was dedicated in Union Square on September 16, 1870, it became the first outdoor statue of Lincoln in America."	 Morgan, <i>The Civil War Lover's Guide to New York City</i> , 2013, p. 68 [page scan]
36	"Originally the statue was surrounded by a fence that bore an inscription of Lincoln's famous words, 'With malice toward none; with charity toward all,' but the fence..."	 Morgan, <i>The Civil War Lover's Guide to New York City</i> , 2013, p. 68 [page scan]
37	"Controversy erupted when the statue was unveiled, due to the fact that Lincoln wore a toga over his suit."	 Swandiak, <i>The 500 Hidden Secrets of New York</i> , 2017, p. 162 [page scan]
38	"Henry Kirke Brown's masterful equestrian statue of Washington, one of the earliest pieces of civic sculpture in the city, was unveiled in 1856."	 Lightfoot, <i>Nineteenth Century in Rare Photographs</i> , 1981, p. 68 [page scan]
39	"A 'slave market' for unemployed actors met near the statue in summer, waiting for possible employers."	 Lightfoot, <i>Nineteenth Century in Rare Photographs</i> , 1981, p. 68 [page scan]
40	"At the end of the century the statue was moved to its present location in the center of the square's park."	 Grafton, <i>New York in the Nineteenth Century</i> , 1977, p. 18 [page scan]
41	"The statue was designed by Frederic-Auguste Bartholdi (who also designed the Statue of Liberty) and is a token of appreciation from the French government for aid..."	 Swandiak, <i>The 500 Hidden Secrets of New York</i> , 2017, p. 162 [page scan]
42	"This statue helped Bartholdi win the commission for the Statue of Liberty a few years later."	 Bergman, <i>The Spiritual Traveler New York City</i> , 2001, p. 133 [page scan]
43	"A statue of Mohandas Gandhi (1869-1948) by Kantilal Patel (1986) stands in the pedestrian triangle at the southwest corner of Union Square."	 Bergman, <i>The Spiritual Traveler New York City</i> , 2001, p. 133 [page scan]
44	"The Parks Department chose this site because of Union Square's tradition of public protests."	 Wolfe, <i>New York 15 Walking Tours</i> , 2003, p. 227 [page scan]
45	"In 1872 the city hired Calvert Vaux and Frederick Law Olmsted, designers of Central Park, to remake Union Square according to a more up-to-date, picturesque aesthetic."	 Leadon, <i>Broadway A History of New York in Thirteen Miles</i> , 2018, p. 118 [page scan]
46	"an estimated crowd of 40,000 to 50,000 squeezed into Union Square to await the midnight commencement of the Fourth of July and the nation's Centennial."	 Leadon, <i>Broadway A History of New York in Thirteen Miles</i> , 2018, p. 118 [page scan]
47	"The numerous brass bands that had marched in the parade were somehow combined into one group, forming an ungainly orchestra of 600 instruments that managed to play..."	 Leadon, <i>Broadway A History of New York in Thirteen Miles</i> , 2018, p. 118 [page scan]

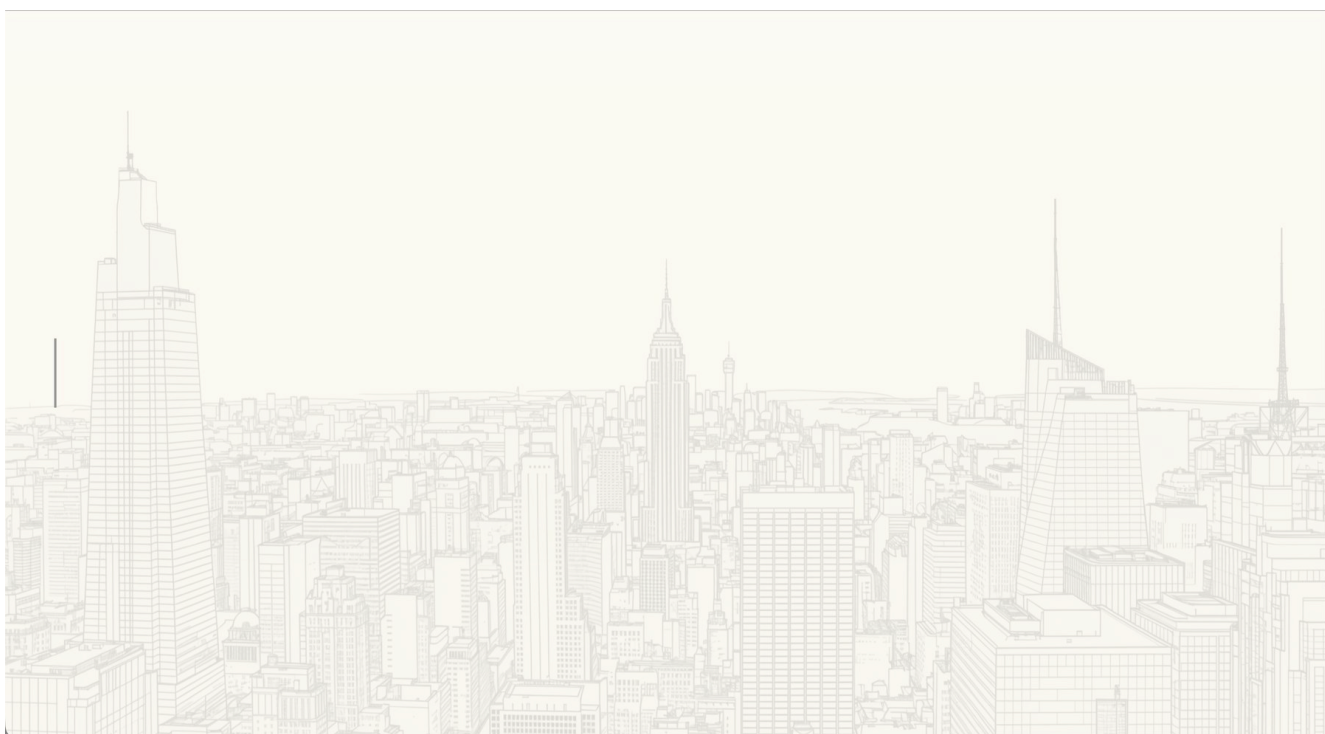
#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
48	"At the stroke of midnight, fireworks rocketed skyward from each corner of the park. Hats were thrown in the air and pistols fired (at least nine people were accidentally..."	 Leadon, <i>Broadway A History of New York in Thirteen Miles</i> , 2018, p. 118 [page scan]
49	"Poet William Cullen Bryant, eighty-one, contributed a special "Centennial Ode.""	 Leadon, <i>Broadway A History of New York in Thirteen Miles</i> , 2018, p. 118 [page scan]
50	"In 1882, the first official labor day parade in the country took place here with nearly twenty-five thousand workers marching in demand of the eight-hour day, an end to..."	 Kayton, <i>Radical Walking Tours of New York City</i> , 1999, p. 80 [page scan]
51	"The organizers, the Central Labor Union, urged workers to sever all ties to the Democratic and Republican Parties, and unite worldwide."	 Kayton, <i>Radical Walking Tours of New York City</i> , 1999, p. 80 [page scan]
52	"In 1910, the ILGWU organized a rally of five thousand here, during the "Uprising of the Twenty Thousand.""	 Kayton, <i>Radical Walking Tours of New York City</i> , 1999, p. 80 [page scan]
53	"The following year, a funeral procession for the victims of the Triangle Shirtwaist Factory Fire marched from Washington Square to Union Square."	 Kayton, <i>Radical Walking Tours of New York City</i> , 1999, p. 80 [page scan]
54	"On March 28, 1908, at a rally of the Socialist Conference of the Unemployed, twenty-two-year-old anarchist Selig Silverstein attempted to throw a homemade bomb at the..."	 Leadon, <i>Broadway A History of New York in Thirteen Miles</i> , 2018, p. 129 [page scan]
55	"The bomb exploded in Silverstein's hands, killing him and a passerby but leaving the police unharmed."	 Leadon, <i>Broadway A History of New York in Thirteen Miles</i> , 2018, p. 129 [page scan]
56	"Berkman, who had been released from prison eight years earlier, staged a "funeral" for the would-be bombers in Union Square."	 Leadon, <i>Broadway A History of New York in Thirteen Miles</i> , 2018, p. 129 [page scan]
57	"Speakers, including anarchists Rebecca Edelson and Charles Plunkett and Wobblies Carlo Tresca and Elizabeth Gurley Flynn, held forth under the watchful eyes of Chief..."	 Leadon, <i>Broadway A History of New York in Thirteen Miles</i> , 2018, p. 129 [page scan]
58	"I want to say it's about time the working class came out frankly and openly and said 'Yes, we believe in violence,'" Edelson, wearing a black dress and red stockings,..."	 Leadon, <i>Broadway A History of New York in Thirteen Miles</i> , 2018, p. 129 [page scan]
59	"I am for violence," Charles Plunkett shouted. "Not only defensive violence, but offensive violence. I don't believe in waiting until we are attacked.""	 Leadon, <i>Broadway A History of New York in Thirteen Miles</i> , 2018, p. 129 [page scan]
60	"That was pretty hot stuff," Schmittberger, a Broadway Squad veteran, remarked when Berkman finished."	 Leadon, <i>Broadway A History of New York in Thirteen Miles</i> , 2018, p. 129 [page scan]
61	"Carlo Tresca spoke on International Worker's Day in 1914, denouncing those who killed thirty-three workers in the Ludlow, Colorado strike at the Rockefeller-owned..."	 Kayton, <i>Radical Walking Tours of New York City</i> , 1999, p. 80 [page scan]
62	"Name the Murderer!" he thundered and the crowd called back "Rockefeller!"	 Kayton, <i>Radical Walking Tours of New York City</i> , 1999, p. 80 [page scan]
63	"In 1893, Emma Goldman was arrested for a speech to the unemployed, wherein she urged those without bread to take it."	 Kayton, <i>Radical Walking Tours of New York City</i> , 1999, p. 80 [page scan]
64	"She spent a year in jail at Blackwell's Island (now Roosevelt Island), learning the nursing trade; she later earned two medical degrees in Europe."	 Kayton, <i>Radical Walking Tours of New York City</i> , 1999, p. 80 [page scan]

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
65	"One of the most famous demonstrations in Union Square was in 1930, when, during the depression, the Communist Party called for nation-wide demonstrations against..."	 Kayton, <i>Radical Walking Tours of New York City</i> , 1999, p. 80 [page scan]
66	"Early in March of 1930 we received a report from our Police Intelligence Squad that 100,000 postal cards had been sent out to members of the Communist Party summoning..."	 Whalen, <i>Mr New York</i> , 1955, p. 155 [page scan]
67	"I was told by my three guests that they did not respect the laws of the United States and the State of New York, or the ordinances of the City of New York, and that they..."	 Whalen, <i>Mr New York</i> , 1955, p. 155 [page scan]
68	"Over 100,000 people had congregated around Union Square by noon. It was one of the largest crowds ever seen there and was the high-water mark in Red demonstrations."	 Whalen, <i>Mr New York</i> , 1955, p. 155 [page scan]
69	"When the committee went back to the crowd it was as if by magic that six portable stands were put up for the speakers and the Soviet flag run up over the American flag."	 Whalen, <i>Mr New York</i> , 1955, p. 155 [page scan]
70	"The police immediately corrected this error and ordered that the flags be reversed before any speakers could address the audience."	 Whalen, <i>Mr New York</i> , 1955, p. 155 [page scan]
71	"Most of the oratory was addressed against "Whalen's Cossacks" and their brutality."	 Whalen, <i>Mr New York</i> , 1955, p. 155 [page scan]
72	"The police cut off movement to the south entirely, so in the end the demonstrators never got below 14th Street."	 Whalen, <i>Mr New York</i> , 1955, p. 155 [page scan]
73	"On June 19, 1953, since the police refused to let organizers use Union Square, several thousand crowded Seventeenth Street adjoining the square to protest the impending..."	 Kayton, <i>Radical Walking Tours of New York City</i> , 1999, p. 80 [page scan]
74	"Artist Andy Warhol moved to the fifth floor of this twelve-story building in 1968."	 Plumb, <i>Notable New York The East Side</i> , 2006, p. 226 [page scan]
75	"The white-walled loft space was called The Factory and housed studios, his office, and a screening room for his films."	 Plumb, <i>Notable New York The East Side</i> , 2006, p. 226 [page scan]
76	"The eleven-story Decker Building on Union Square was designed by John Edelman, an architect known to have anarchist sympathies, for the Decker Piano Co."	 Kiedrowski, <i>Andy Warhols New York</i> , 2011, p. 93 [page scan]
77	"A stuffed Great Dane (which Warhol hinted had belonged to Cecil B. DeMille—though the staff could never match it to any photos of DeMille's dogs) stood next to the..."	 Kiedrowski, <i>Andy Warhols New York</i> , 2011, p. 93 [page scan]
78	"On June 3, 1968, Valerie Solanas, an occasional Factory visitor and sole member of SCUM (Society for Cutting Up Men), came to Warhol's office here, pulled a revolver and..."	 Plumb, <i>Notable New York The East Side</i> , 2006, p. 226 [page scan]
79	"Warhol was pronounced dead at the hospital but, miraculously, managed to survive."	 Plumb, <i>Notable New York The East Side</i> , 2006, p. 226 [page scan]
80	"The crazed Solanas surrendered to the police a few hours after the shooting. She served a three-year sentence and died in 1988. Warhol lived until 1987."	 Plumb, <i>Notable New York The East Side</i> , 2006, p. 226 [page scan]

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
81	"By 1974, Warhol had run out of space at his Union Square studio called The Factory and, in August of that year, he moved across the street to this six-story brick..."	 Plumb, <i>Notable New York The East Side</i> , 2006, p. 226 [page scan]
82	"Always economical, Warhol made it a condition that all visitors to The Factory during the move had to carry at least one item across the street to the new building."	 Plumb, <i>Notable New York The East Side</i> , 2006, p. 226 [page scan]
83	"One of the first was accidental: Warhol's Time Capsules."	 Kiedrowski, <i>Andy Warhols New York</i> , 2011, p. 97 [page scan]
84	"He reenergized his image by producing artwork with younger artists of the time, notably Keith Haring, Jean-Michel Basquiat, and Francesco Clemente."	 Kiedrowski, <i>Andy Warhols New York</i> , 2011, p. 97 [page scan]
85	"Painter Arshile Gorky worked on his art in a studio on this site from 1929 until his death in 1948."	 Plumb, <i>Notable New York The East Side</i> , 2006, p. 231 [page scan]
86	"Gorky was an Armenian born in Turkey who came to New York in 1925."	 Plumb, <i>Notable New York The East Side</i> , 2006, p. 231 [page scan]
87	"Gorky treated his working space here as a sacred area—he scrubbed the floor weekly, stocked it with the best materials, and hung life-size photographs of his favorite..."	 Plumb, <i>Notable New York The East Side</i> , 2006, p. 231 [page scan]
88	"Gorky committed suicide by hanging in Connecticut on July 21, 1948 at the age of forty-eight."	 Plumb, <i>Notable New York The East Side</i> , 2006, p. 231 [page scan]
89	"IN 1870, TIFFANY'S DEMOLISHED the James Renwick-designed Church of the Puritans on the west side of Union Square and replaced it with a huge cast-iron store-the "Palace..."	 Leadon, <i>Broadway A History of New York in Thirteen Miles</i> , 2018, p. 118 [page scan]
90	"It is interesting to note that Agosto Brentano, who came to America as a poor cripple from Sicily, eked out a living selling newspapers and periodicals, and ultimately..."	 Wolfe, <i>New York 15 Walking Tours</i> , 2003, p. 252 [page scan]
91	"The bank was organized in 1871, and commenced operations in June of that year."	 King, <i>King's Handbook of New York City</i> , 1892, p. 689 [page scan]
92	"Charles L. Tiffany, of Tiffany & Company; Hon. Samuel Sloan, President of the Delaware, Lackawanna & Western Railroad; Robert Schell, the President; Joseph Park, of Park..."	 King, <i>King's Handbook of New York City</i> , 1892, p. 689 [page scan]
93	"The single-tax economist Henry George died here on October 29, 1897."	 AIA, <i>AIA Guide to New York City Edition 3</i> , 1988, p. 185 [page scan]
94	"By 1920, former gang leader Monk Eastman was trying to lead a life along the straight and narrow."	 Ferrara, <i>A Guide to Gangsters</i> , 2009, p. 181 [page scan]
95	"So, he got involved with a crooked Prohibition agent, who on December 26 of that year shot and killed Eastman in a drunken dispute on the sidewalk outside this address."	 Ferrara, <i>A Guide to Gangsters</i> , 2009, p. 181 [page scan]
96	"That sturdy descendant of the Knickerbockers, Gulian C. Verplanck, died at 12 East Sixteenth Street."	 Wilson, <i>New York in Literature</i> , 1947, p. 128 [page scan]
97	"I see a great deal of Mark Twain nowadays," he wrote his sister from this address, "and we have good times denouncing even thing. We are old fellows, and it is pleasant..."	 Wilson, <i>New York in Literature</i> , 1947, p. 128 [page scan]

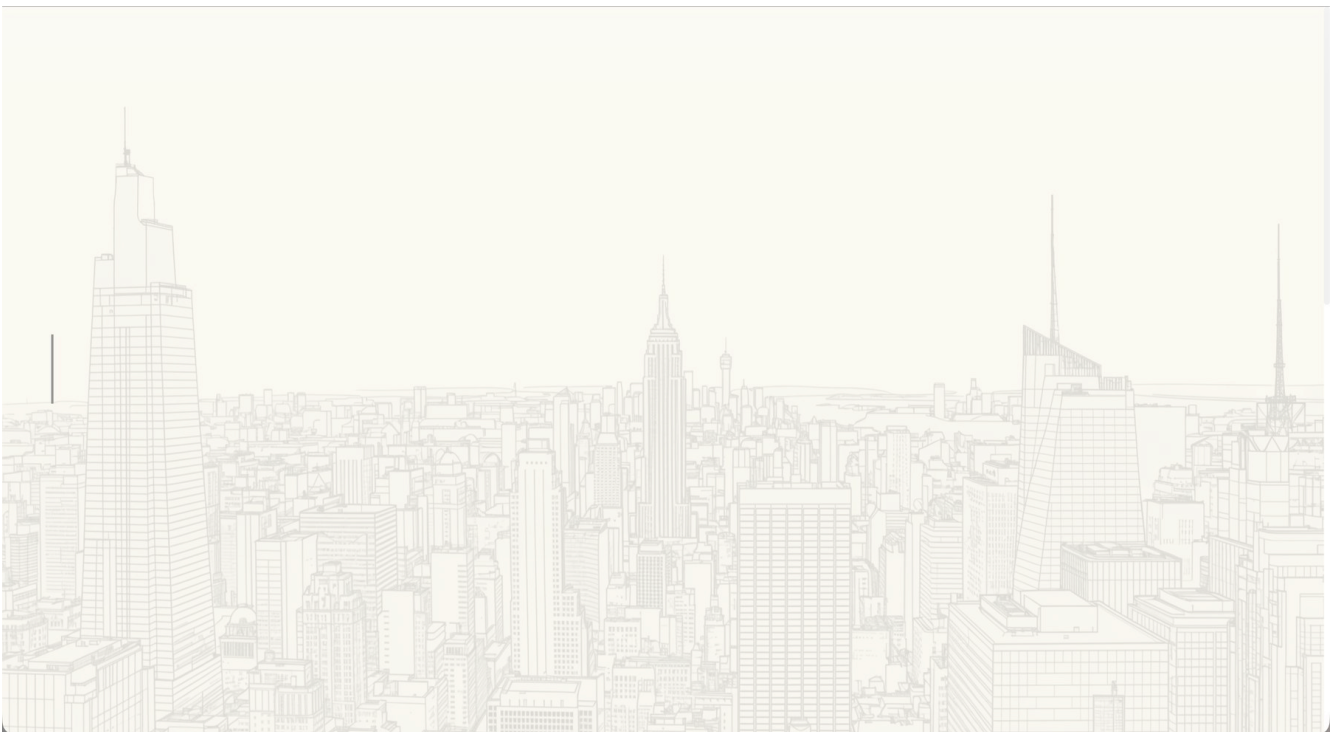
SOURCE PAGES

23 scanned pages, one per cited source page. Each lists the highlighted quotes drawn from it.



Kayton, *Radical Walking Tours of New York City*, 1999, p. 80

Quotes drawn from this page: 1 2 4 50 51 52 53 61 62 63 64 65 73



8 **WORKER'S LAB THEATER (42 East Twelfth Street)**—This radical theater collective was established in 1929 to reach the masses with political street theater. The core members of The Shock Troupe lived in the building, performing full time at Union Square, workers' picnics, strike sites, and in the subways. In the 1930s, they performed *World's Fair* in opposition to Chicago's World Fair.

The tradition was continued in the early 1990s by the Nicaragua Network's group Adelante!, which attacked politicians, the Gulf War, and racism at demonstrations, festivals and on the subways. (While doing guerrilla theater in Manhattan, I was amazed to learn how many public sidewalks are in reality privately owned.)

9 **CLARENDON HALL (112-114 East Thirteenth Street)**—The Central Labor Union (CLU), founded in 1882, held meetings here and at the Science Hall at 141 E. Eighth Street. The first labor day parade in the United States was planned here and held later in the year at Union Square (see next site).

In 1886, the CLU invited four hundred delegates and 165 organizations here to fight an anti-labor mayoral campaign, nominating progressive Henry George. He finished second with sixty-eight thousand votes to Abram Hewitt, Peter Cooper's political-hack brother-in-law, but beat out Theodore Roosevelt, the Republican candidate, by eight thousand votes.

In 1900, there was a meeting here to establish *The New York Call*, the influential socialist newspaper that became the unofficial organ of the Socialist Party (see City Hall Tour). They featured the best coverage of the 1911 Triangle Shirtwaist Fire.

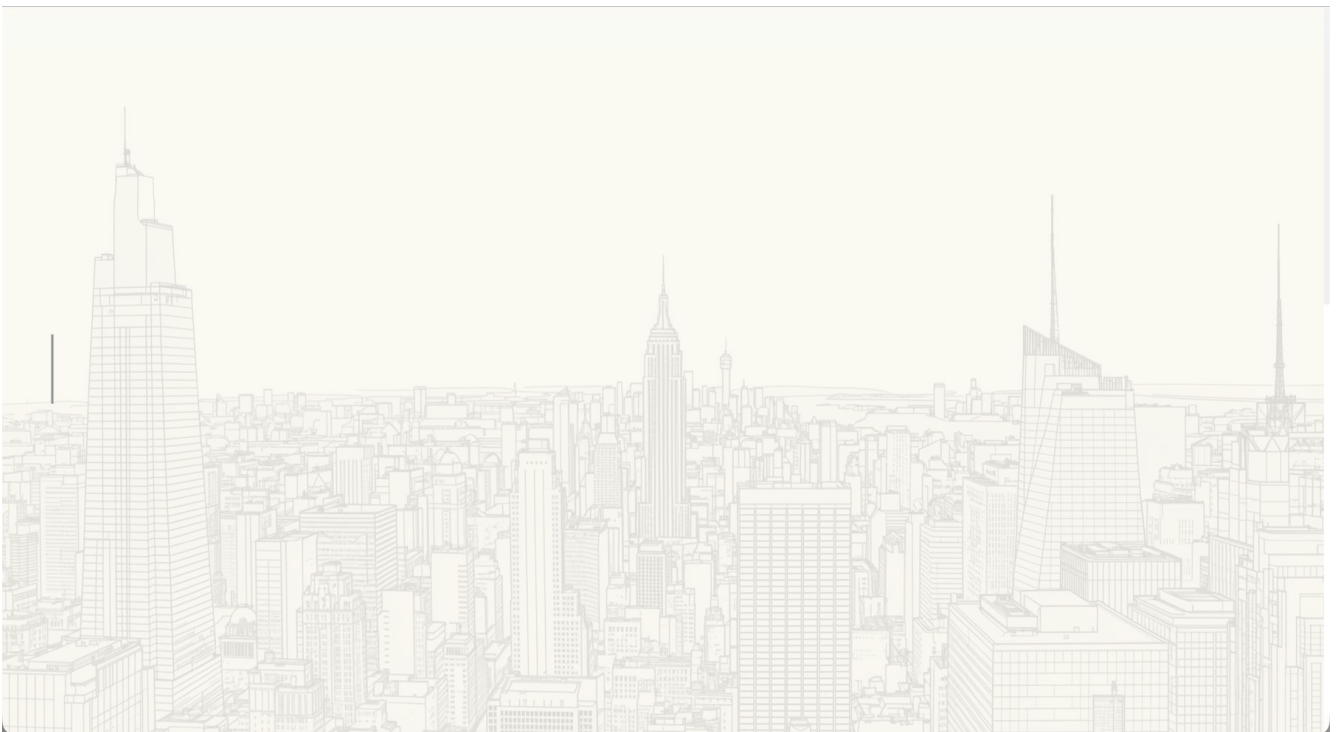
845.1

10 **UNION SQUARE**—Named for the union of Broadway

and Fourth Avenue (not the large number of union headquarters historically in the area), Union Square was completed in

Wolfe, *New York 15 Walking Tours*, 2003, p. 227

Quotes drawn from this page: 3 44





845.2

The equestrian statue of Washington, by Henry Kirke Brown and John Quincy Adams Ward, executed in 1856 and considered one of the finest in America, is seen here at the intersection of Fourth Avenue (now Park Avenue South) and 14th Street. With the advent of the motor age, it was moved into adjacent Union Square. (Museum of the City of New York)

845.1

bach's moved uptown to 34th Street to join other department stores that had abandoned Ladies' Mile, but in 1984, it closed its doors forever.

At the southwest corner of Union Square, on a small triangular plaza, is the statue of Mohandas Gandhi, executed by Kantilal B. Patel in 1986. Here we see Mahatma Gandhi dressed in his dhoti and carrying his familiar walking stick. The Parks Department chose this site because of Union Square's tradition of public protests.

For the Broadway horsecars and omnibuses, making the detour around Union Square presented no problem; but when the later cable cars were installed a major traffic hazard was created. The forward progress of the Broadway Cable Traction Company's cars was controlled by continuous sections of underground cable laid in a slot between the rails. To negotiate the sharp curve, the operator of the car, called the grip-man, had to get up speed, release his hold on the 14th Street cable section, stamp furiously on his warning bell as the car swung wildly around the bend, then catch the next underground cable section on Broadway. This repeated act of derring-do always attracted crowds of onlookers, and resulted in numerous accidents—some fatal—and the spot was soon called "Dead Man's Curve." [See Cable Building, page 204, and photo, page 228.]

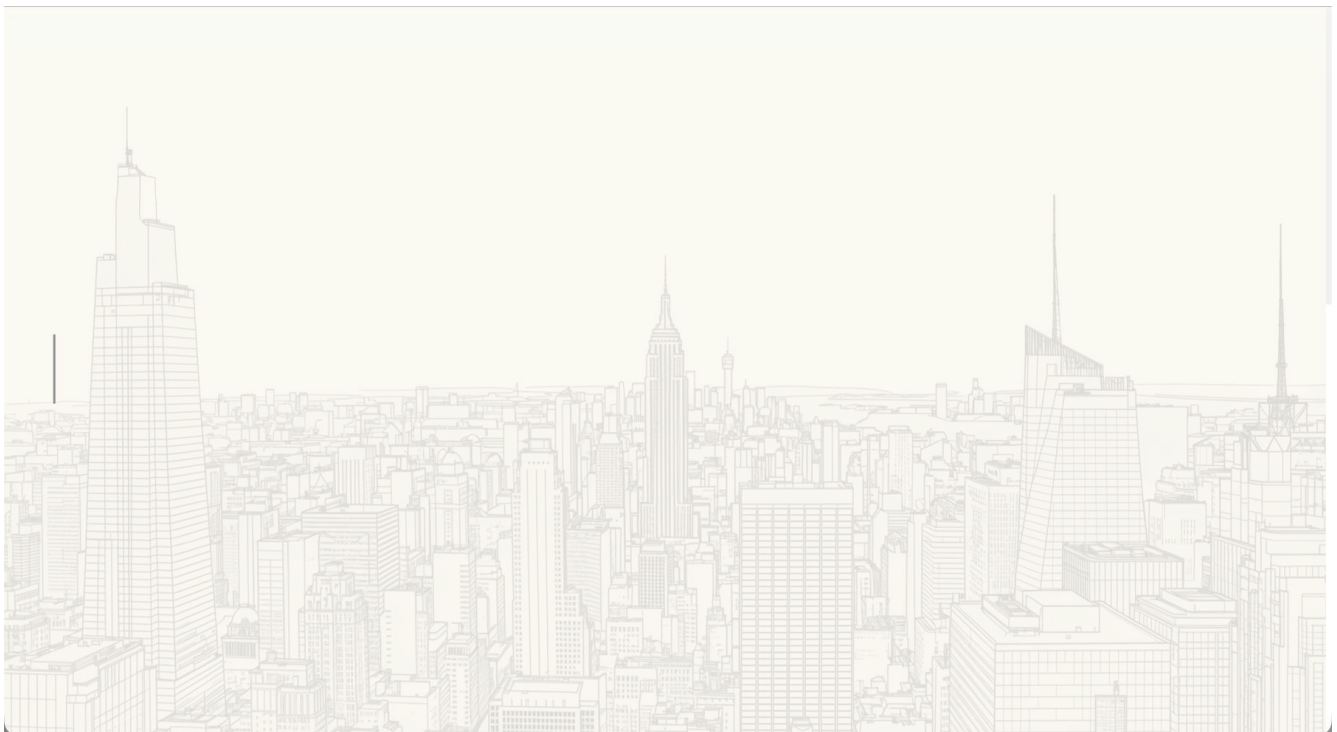
7. Continue west on the north side of 14th Street, passing the former Baumann Brothers & Co. store, at 22 East 14th Street (D. & J. Jardine, 1881), a large, ornate, cast-iron edifice whose "modernized" ground floor belies its Classic-style upper façade. Baumann Brothers was a popular carpet store whose business lasted well into the 20th century.

8. Midway between Fifth and Sixth avenues, on the south side of 14th Street (No. 34–40), a small vestige remains of what was once a prosperous and dynamic enterprise, James A. Hearn & Son. Arriving on 14th Street in 1879 after a brief association downtown with his uncle Aaron Arnold (later of Arnold, Constable & Company), James A. Hearn built up a large dry-goods business, and soon became an aggressive rival of R. H. Macy, then at the corner of Sixth Avenue. The two

merchants often indulged in cutthroat competition, to their mutual detriment and the customers' delight. It is said that Japanese silk, a favorite with the ladies of the day, was offered by Macy at 41 cents per yard, whereupon Hearn immediately dropped the price by a few cents; and Macy followed suit. Again and again the

Leadon, *Broadway A History of New York in Thirteen Miles*, 2018, p. 112

Quotes drawn from this page: 5 6 7 8 33



844

glass, lived in a large house at the corner of Broadway and 14th Street, facing the southern edge of the square. (It was from a window on the second floor of that house that six-year-old Theodore Roosevelt, Cornelius's grandson, watched Abraham Lincoln's funeral procession pass slowly down Broadway in 1865.) James F. Penniman, a manufacturer of linseed oil, built a fabulously appointed brownstone mansion at 42 East 14th Street, just west of Roosevelt. Henry Parish, an importer of silk, built an opulent mansion, stuffed with Old Master paintings and featuring an oval stair ascending to a central dome, with an attached conservatory in the side yard, at the southwest corner of Broadway and 17th Street. Robert Goelet, heir to a family fortune made in hardware, lived directly across 17th Street from Parish, while, two blocks to the north, Goelet's brother Peter built a mysterious brick house set back from the street on one-third of an acre of lawn stocked with strutting peacocks. (Peter Goelet's house wasn't demolished until 1896.)

"This is now the *fashionable quarter*," the editors of the annual *New York Gazetteer* declared in 1842. But only five years later, Madison Square, six blocks to the north, opened and began luring residents northward once again. Moving had become a consuming passion in New York, an exaggerated version of the restless American desire for constant change.

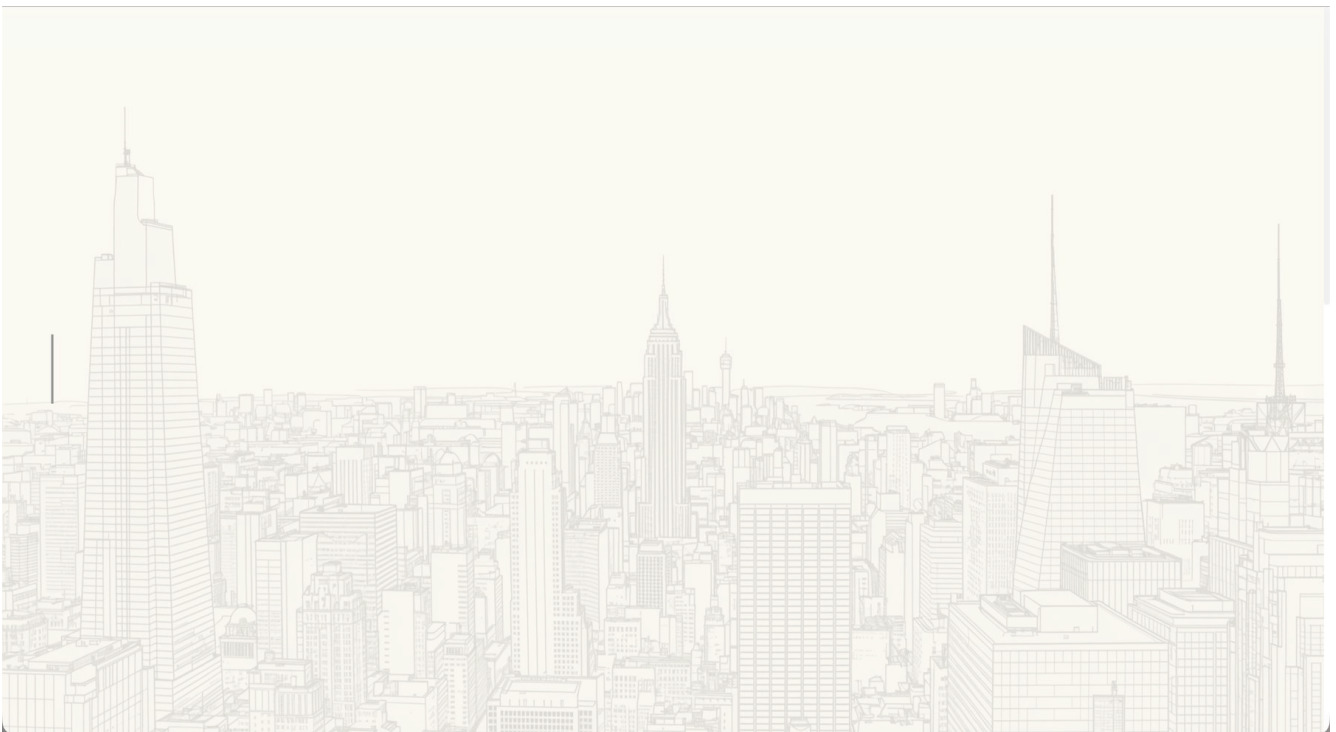
"That's the way to live in New York—to move every three or four years," Arthur Townsend, a geographically ambitious young swain, pontificates in Henry James's novel *Washington Square*, in which its protagonist, Catherine, is doomed not only to an unmarried life, but an unmarried life below 14th Street. "Then you always get the last thing. It's because the city's growing so quick—you've got to keep up with it. It's going straight up town—that's where New York's going."

On the eve of the Civil War, Union Square was still a residential neighborhood but, because the city had grown so far to the north, was beginning to feel like the center of town.

AROUND MIDNIGHT on April 14, 1861, Walt Whitman was walking down Broadway on his way home to Brooklyn when he heard the shouts of newsboys announcing the surrender of Fort Sumter.

Morgan, *The Civil War Lover's Guide to New York City*, 2013, p. 68

Quotes drawn from this page: 9 10 14 15 16 17 18 19 23 24 25 26 30 31 32 34 35 36



067. UNION SQUAREBroadway and East 14th Street

For nearly two centuries, Union Square has been the site of historic demonstrations and political rallies on a giant scale. During the Civil War, it was the site of many protests, speeches, and parades. On April 20, 1861, a mass rally held here supported Lincoln's call for 75,000 volunteers. A crowd estimated at 100,000 to 250,000 people turned out to listen to the 20 dignitaries scheduled to speak that day. The highlight was the appearance of the Union officer who had been in command of Fort Sumter, Maj. Robert Anderson (1805–1871). Following his surrender on April 13, 1861, he and his men had been allowed to return north aboard the *Baltic*, arriving in New York harbor on April 19. Although a Southerner by birth and pro-slavery himself, Anderson remained loyal to the Union. He was promoted to brigadier general and became the North's first national hero. The flag that had flown over Fort Sumter was draped over the equestrian statue of George Washington at the south end of the square. The crowd that wildly cheered Anderson that day was the largest ever assembled in the country, and the *New York Tribune* reported it as "the greatest popular demonstration ever known in America."





(Top left) Major Robert Anderson; (Above) Rally in Union Square, April 20, 1861.

Jenkins, *The Greatest Street in the World*, 1911, pp. 225-226

Quotes drawn from this page: 11 12 13

From Union Square to Forty-Second Street 225

be a good thing if popular subscription would take it down again and erect in its place a truly artistic statue of the Great Liberator commensurate with the greatness of the subject and of the city which desires to do him honor.

For many years the park was enclosed by an iron



THE WEST SIDE OF UNION SQUARE IN 1897. 845.1

railing; but about twenty years ago, the city authorities awakened to the fact that the public parks should be free at all hours, especially at night in our hot spells, and the fence was removed. The fountain was erected in anticipation of the admission of Croton water and played for the first time upon the day of the great celebration in 1842. Several smaller fountains for drinking places have been erected about the park, and on the

15

226 The World's Greatest Street

north is a house of comfort with a platform facing the open space of Seventeenth Street from which speakers can address the crowds upon public occasions. This has been a favorite out-door gathering place upon May-day and Labor day for the socialistically inclined; and one can listen upon such occasions to a variety of denunciations by wild-eyed and long-haired foreign citizens. You may not be able to understand anything they say except the one word *capitalisten*, which is hurled with such obvious and bitter hatred that you come to the conclusion that it cannot mean anything else but capitalists. At a meeting of this sort on March 28, 1908, a bomb was hurled at the police, but fortunately no one was killed except the hurler of the missile. For some years an open air flower market has been held in the early morning at the north end of the Square.

Of a different class from the socialistic meetings was the great meeting in Union Square on the twentieth of April, 1861, when at three o'clock in the afternoon, over one hundred thousand people assembled in mass convention to take steps to redress the insult to the flag, which had been fired upon at Sumter less than ten days before. The meeting was presided over by John A. Dix with eighty-seven vice-presidents from the leading men of the community; among whose names you will find only half a dozen, which, at that time, would have been called foreign. The list began with Peter Cooper and ended with John J. Astor. The most famous of the orators who addressed the meeting was Senator Baker of Oregon, who, during the Mexican War, had led a New York regiment to the gates of the city of Mexico, and who, a few months later, was to give his life for the Union upon the disastrous field of Ball's Bluff, on the soil of the Old Dominion. The resolutions adopted by the

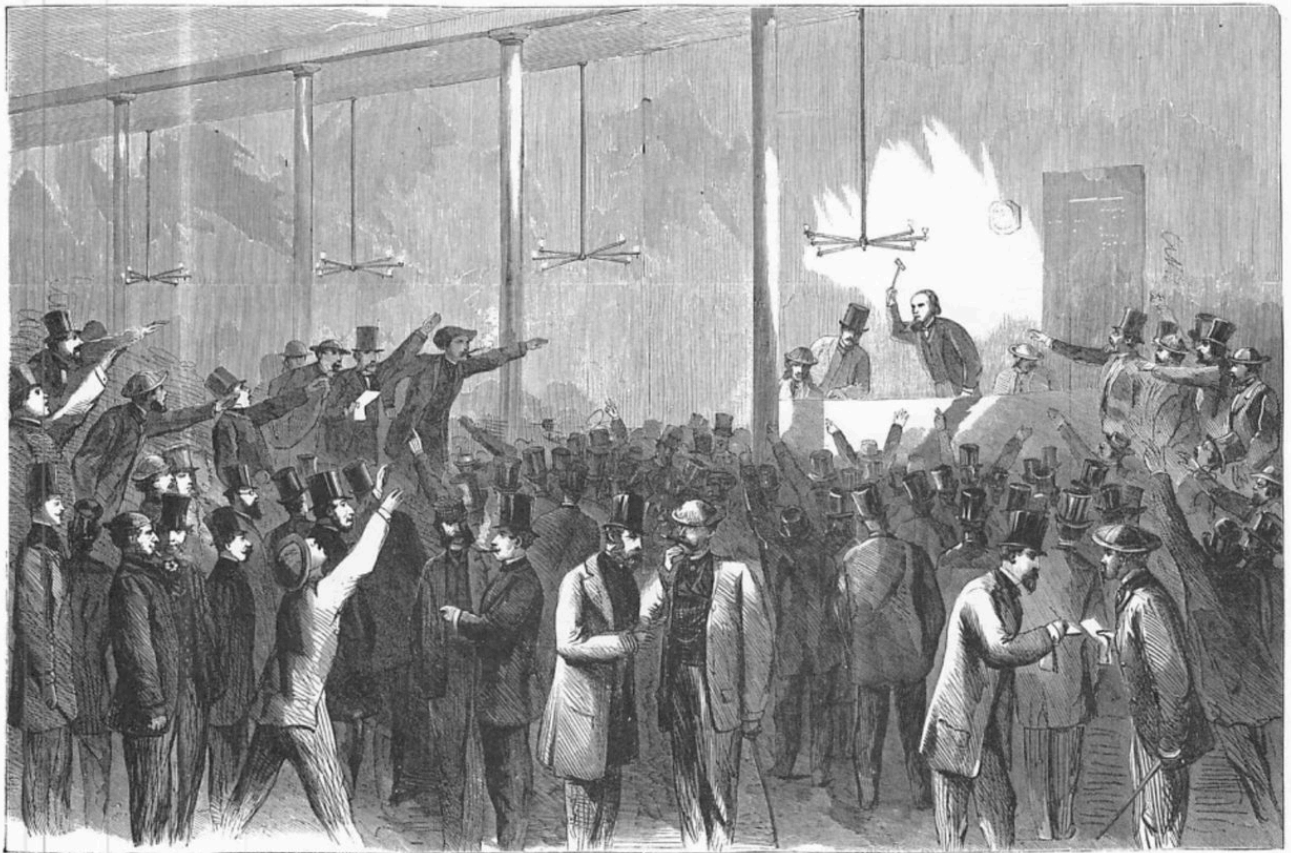
845.1



Grafton, *New York in the Nineteenth Century*, 1977, p. 23

Quotes drawn from this page: 20 21 22





CIVIL WAR: THE METROPOLITAN FAIR, 1864 (Opposite, Top). Beside the thousands of soldiers—both volunteers and draftees—who came from New York to join the Union Army, the city's greatest contribution to the cause was the Metropolitan or Sanitary Fair, opened on April 4, 1864 for the benefit of the United States Sanitary Commission. The buildings, erected especially for the occasion, stood on Union Square and along West 14th Street. The Commission had been founded in 1861 to raise funds for medical supplies for the Union Army, to staff field hospitals, to care for sick and wounded soldiers and to oversee and improve the generally deplorable health conditions under which an unprepared nation sent its soldiers to fight and under which it cared for them when they were wounded or fell ill. Before the work of the Commission had effect, field treatment of soldiers was at a rudimentary level. Overcrowding, disease, poor provisions and a general lack of care marked military encampments early in the war. Under difficulties and against great odds, the Commission succeeded in improving these conditions better than anyone could have expected. New Yorkers dominated the Commission. Frederick Law Olmsted, designer of Central Park, served as its general secretary; Henry W. Bellows, pastor of All Souls Unitarian

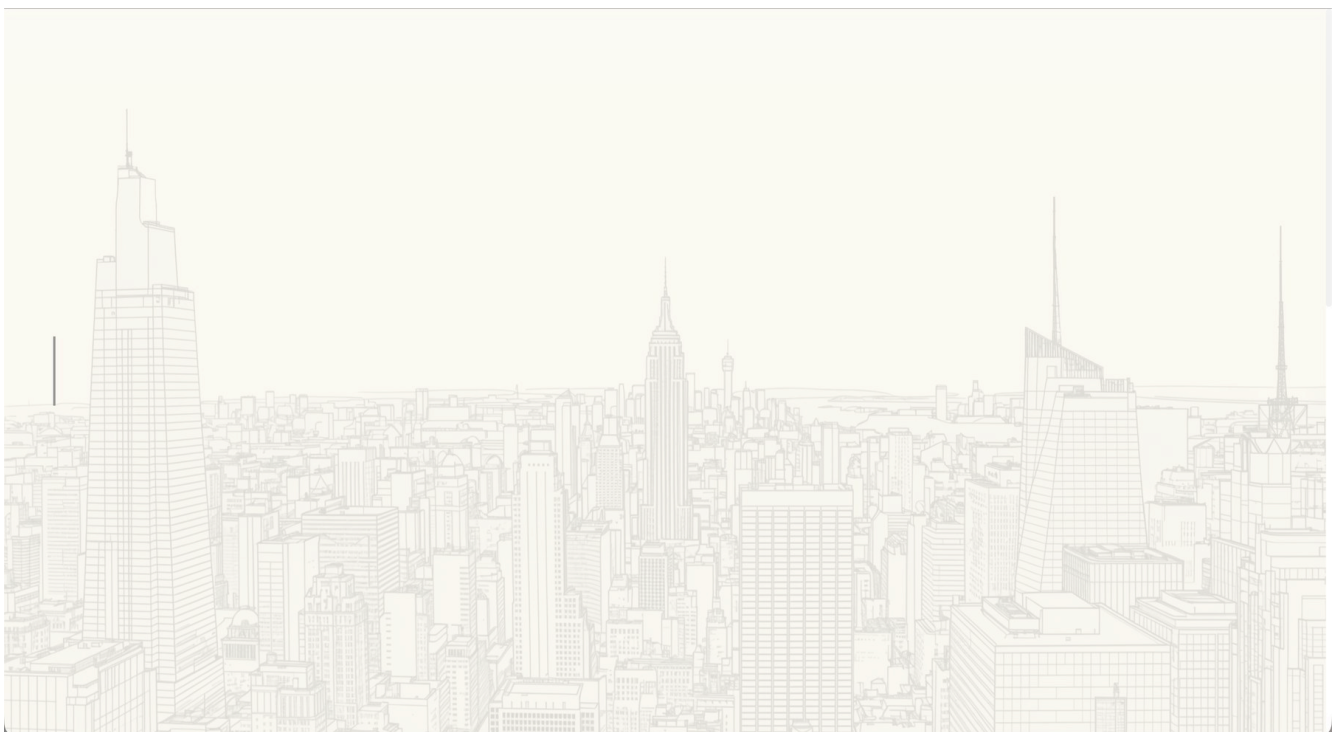
whose lengthy and readable diary, discovered and published only in the middle of the twentieth century, is one of the major sources for details of New York life in the middle of the nineteenth century, especially during the war years. (*Harper's Weekly*; April 23, 1864.) THE PICTURE GALLERY OF THE METROPOLITAN FAIR, 1864 (Opposite, Bottom). In this ~~WAS XXXXXXX~~ building of the Metropolitan Fair paintings which had been donated were sold to benefit the Sanitary Commission. Articles of every description were sold in the fair's various departments and by the time it closed over a million dollars had been raised. Similar fairs in other Northern cities helped to maintain the Commission throughout the War. (*Harper's Weekly*, April 16, 1864.) STOCK GAMBLING AT GALLAGHER'S, 1864 (Above). The war gave a great boost to speculation in stocks and prices rose considerably. There was so much activity that an enterprising gentleman named Gallagher opened this evening stock exchange at the Fifth Avenue Hotel to supplement daytime trading at the New York Stock Exchange. Eventually the bubble burst; financial scandals caused the directors of the New York Stock Exchange to announce that they would suspend any broker who participated at Gallagher's, and the new exchange disappeared as fast as it had

Church, was its president. One tireless worker for the Commission sprung up. (*Harper's Weekly*, May 7, 1864.)
throughout the war was New York lawyer George Templeton Strong,

MEMORABLE EVENTS

Strausbaugh, *City of Sedition*, 2016, p. 293

Quotes drawn from this page: 27 28 29



States Colored Troops. They were recruited and outfitted by the wealthy Republicans of the Union League Club. Union Leagues, also called Loyal Leagues, had sprung up all around the North to counter the dismal morale that had spread by the start of 1863. Henry Bellows, Frederick Law Olmsted, the lawyer George Templeton Strong, and other Sanitary Commission leaders started New York City's Union League Club in February 1863, and wooed some five hundred others. Club members were the cream of Protestant, patrician New York, including the influential businessman Alexander Stewart and the shipping magnate William Aspinwall, along with politicians like Dix and the former governor and now senator Edwin Morgan. When the draft riots raged around their posh clubhouse on East 17th Street, near both Union Square and Edwin Booth's home, club members like Strong had seethed helplessly at the "brutal, base, cruel... Irish scum" and the "unspeakable infamy of the nigger persecution." In November they went over the head of the objecting Governor Seymour and won Stanton's permission to recruit black volunteers to help fill New York's quota.

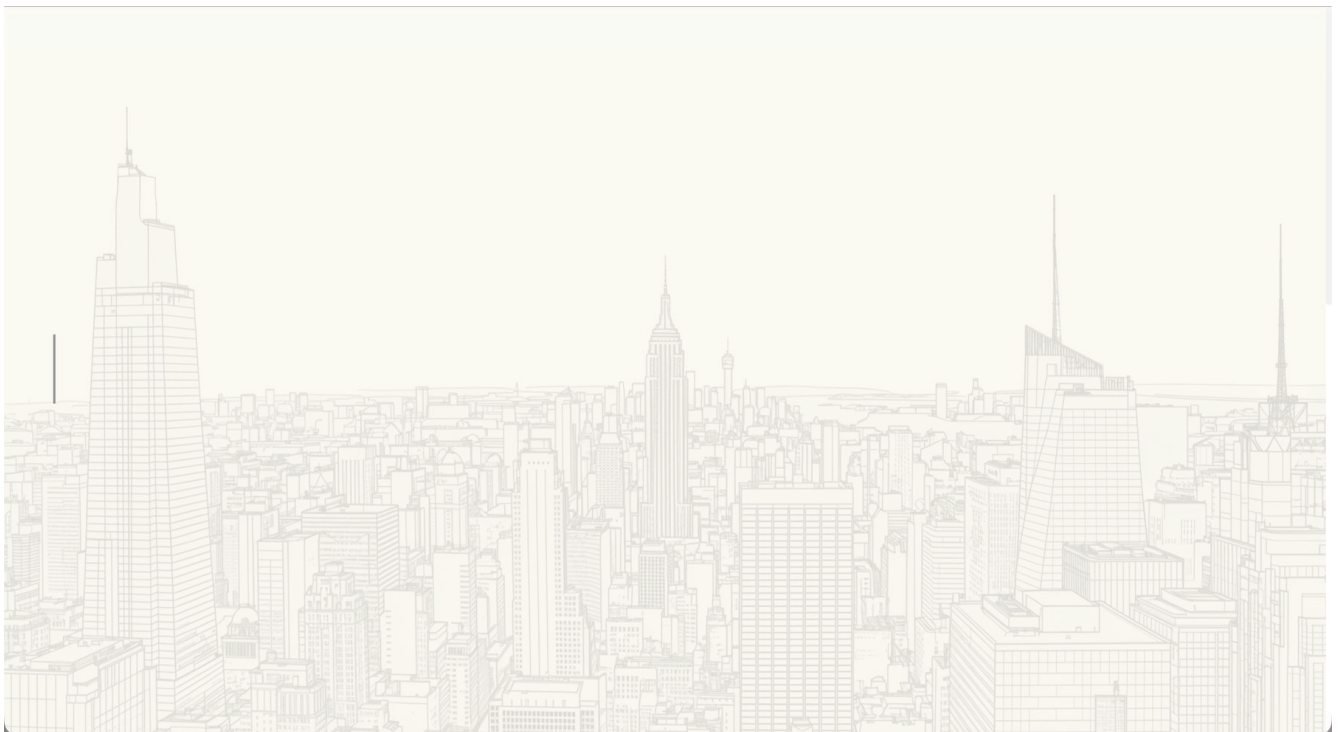
On March 5, 1864, the 20th's 1,020 black soldiers marched from the clubhouse to a waiting steamship while tens of thousands lined their route, some cheering and some just gawking. The club would raise a second regiment, the 26th, and part of a third, the 31st, by which point the city's complement of eligible black men had been largely depleted. Many of the soldiers had left jobs paying up to sixty dollars a month to take ten dollars (three less than white soldiers) from the army. As was customary with black regiments, the officers and noncommissioned officers were all white men, except for the chaplain. Reverend Henry Highland Garnet served as chaplain while the regiment trained on Rikers Island, but he could not go to the front with them because he limped on a wooden leg, the result of a boyhood injury. He was replaced by the Reverend George Le Vere of Brooklyn as the unit prepared to leave the city.

While some New Yorkers cheered the men of the 20th, others went out of their way to discourage them. The brokers through whom they signed up cheated them even more grossly than they did white recruits. Facilities on Rikers Island were abysmal. Reverend Garnet was so badly mistreated on the ferry to the island that the army had to assign him an escort. When Le Vere took over, white officers refused to let him eat with them in the mess; even the club neglected to invite him to a reception for the regiment's officers. Two of the city's most famous marching bands, Harvey



Swandiak, *The 500 Hidden Secrets of New York*, 2017, p. 162

Quotes drawn from this page: 37 41



5 monuments to **GREAT MEN and WOMEN**

26

291 **FEARLESS
GIRL STATUE**

Broad St

(betw Wall St
and Exchange Pl)

Financial District ①

New York has fallen in love with this delightfully valiant little girl. The bronze sculpture by Kristen Visbal depicts a defiant lass – who once stood facing the bull of Wall Street. The statue initially appeared on International Women's Day to symbolize female empowerment. It now has its permanent spot in front of the New York Stock Exchange.

292 **MARQUIS
DE LAFAYETTE**

Park Avenue South

845 (at E 16th St and east
end of **Union Square**)
Union Square ⑤

This French nobleman came to the aid of the colonies in their fight against the British during the Revolutionary War. The statue was designed by Frédéric-Auguste Bartholdi (who also designed the Statue of Liberty) and is a token of appreciation from the French government for aid provided during the Franco-Prussian War.

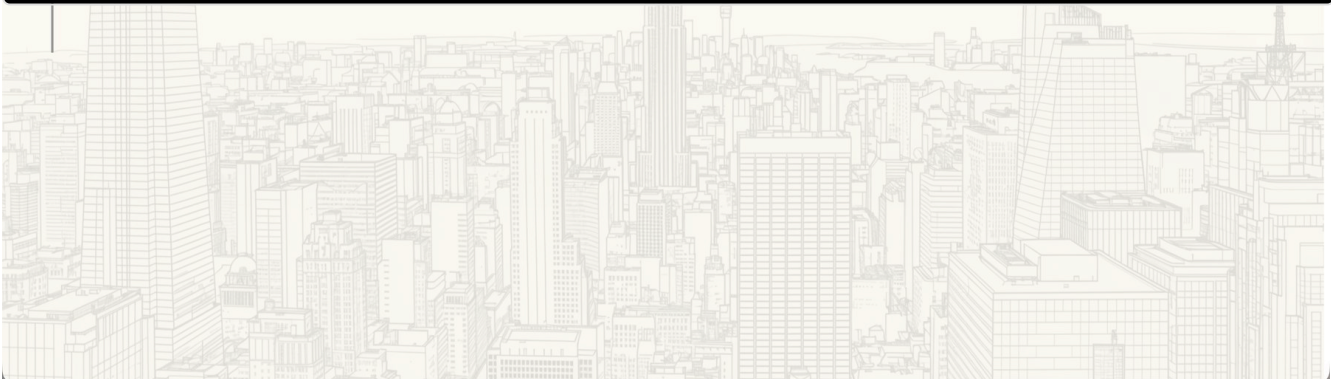
Lightfoot, *Nineteenth Century in Rare Photographs*, 1981, p. 68

Quotes drawn from this page: 38 39



871.1

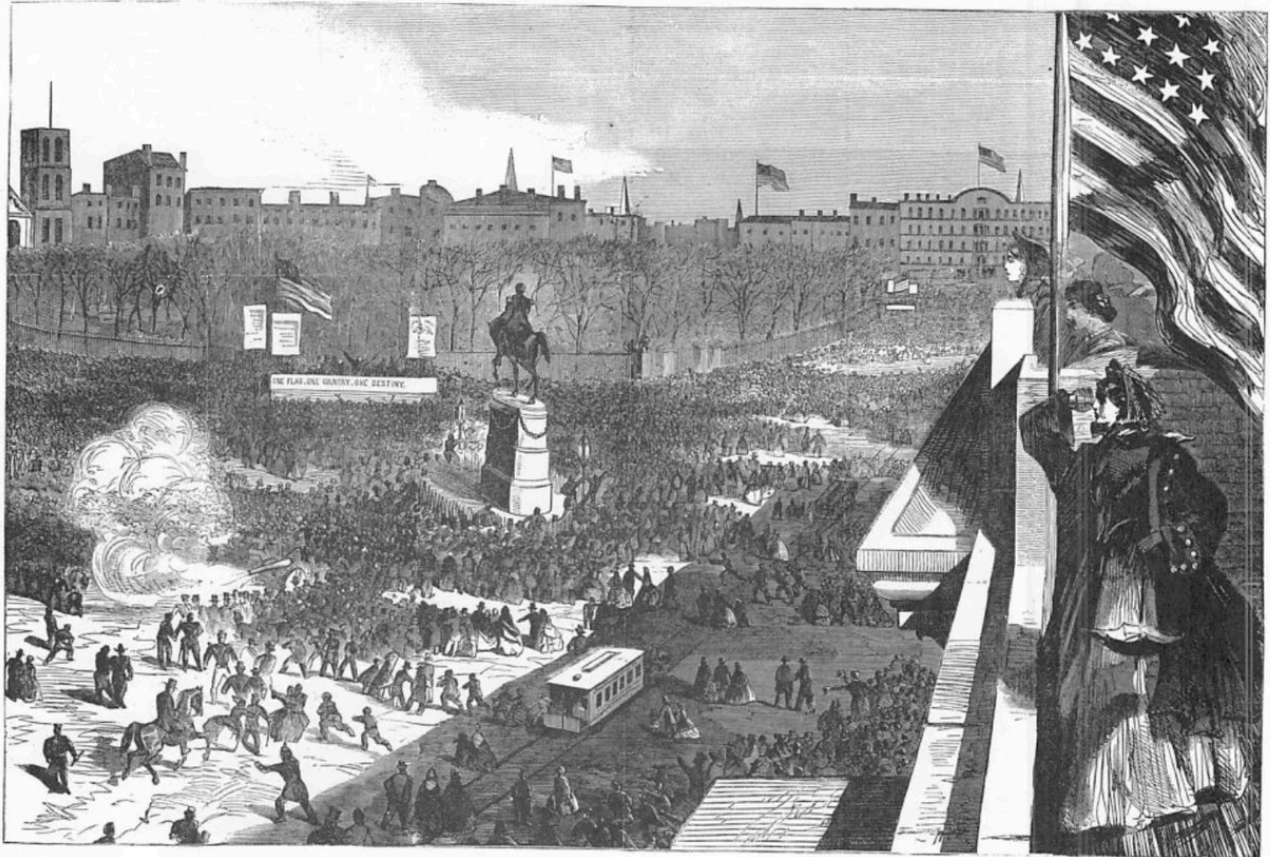
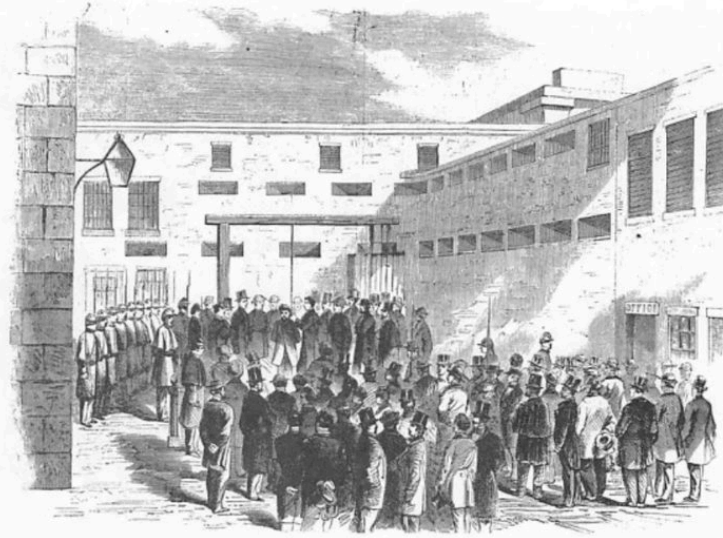
68. The Washington Statue in Union Square, ca. 1871; publisher unknown. Henry Kirke Brown's masterful equestrian statue of Washington, one of the earliest pieces of civic sculpture in the city, was unveiled in 1856. A "slave market" for unemployed actors met near the statue in summer, waiting for possible employers. A miscellaneous group of gamins pose for the photographer at the base of the statue.



Grafton, *New York in the Nineteenth Century*, 1977, p. 18

Quotes drawn from this page: 40





CIVIL WAR: EXECUTION OF CAPTAIN GORDON, 1862 (Top). The hanging of Nathaniel P. Gordon, a captain of a slave-trading ship which had been captured by the United States Navy off the coast of Africa, took place in New York on February 21, 1862. Although slave trading had long been a capital crime, few offenders were prosecuted for it by the United States government before the start of the Civil War. Efforts had been made to have Captain Gordon's sentence commuted, but Lincoln had refused to consider these petitions. Diarist George Templeton Strong, applauding the President's firmness in this case, reported that the condemned man had in fact

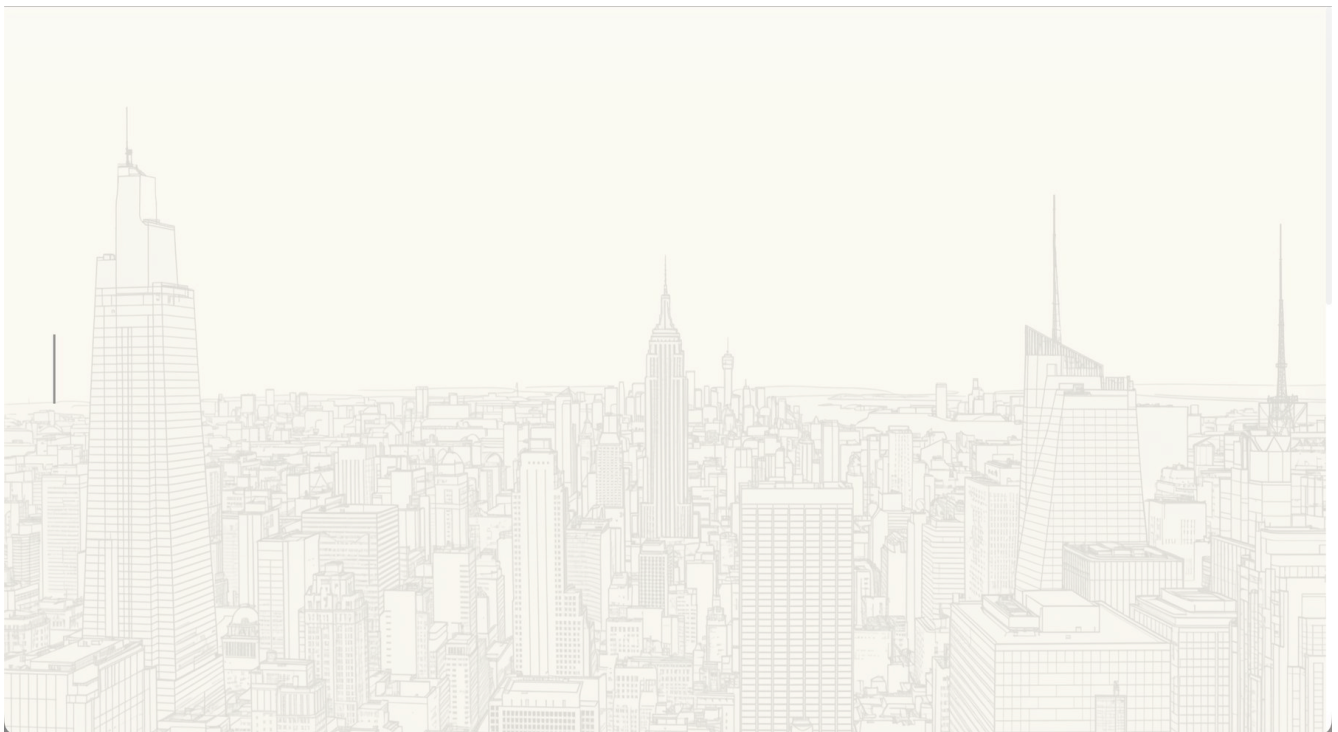
and it was all the doctors could do to keep him alive until he could be publicly hanged. (*Harper's Weekly*; March 8, 1862.) **SUMTER MEETING IN UNION SQUARE, APRIL 11, 1863 (Bottom).** The second anniversary of the attack on Fort Sumter was the occasion for this rally, seen here at the juncture of 14th Street and Fourth Avenue at the square's southeast corner. The focal point of the meeting is the equestrian statue of George Washington by Henry K. Brown and J. Q. A. Ward, standing on the site where it had been installed in 1856. At the end of the century the statue was moved to its present location in the center of the square's park. (*Harper's Weekly*; April

swallowed a near-fatal dose of strychnine just before his execution (25, 1863.)

18 MEMORABLE EVENTS

Bergman, *The Spiritual Traveler New York City*, 2001, p. 133

Quotes drawn from this page: 42 43



Ecuadorians was granted the right to bring a copy of the Madonna of Quinche from their homeland. The Lady, a small statue of the Madonna and Child, is installed in an exquisite gilded shrine, and Ecuadorian women regularly change the beautiful and elaborate dresses they have sewn for her. Each week planes from Ecuador bring fresh long-stemmed roses to adorn the sanctuary.

Today St. Ann's offers masses in English, Armenian, Spanish, and, by special dispensation, traditional Latin.

AROUND THE CORNER

➡ **Immaculate Conception Roman Catholic Church** (LM, 406–412 East 14th St., between First and Ave. A. 1896, Barney & Chapman. ☎ 254-0200) was built by Grace Church (see p. 130) as an Episcopalian chapel and social service center in what was then a poor immigrant neighborhood. Today we see only half of what this complex once was, but it still resembles a medieval urban church, looking after the spiritual, educational, and physical needs of its parish. The style of the buildings is late-Gothic or early-Renaissance French, featuring a bold tower on 14th Street, a church, and a small chapel. The buildings to the east of the tower were originally a hospital and community center, but are today clerical housing and offices. The central parking lot used to be a courtyard, and buildings on 13th Street included the rectory, a clubhouse, and the parish building with parlors and a reading room, Sunday school and cooking classes, and even a gym and swimming pool. The Roman Catholic Church bought this property in 1943. The belief in the Immaculate Conception—that Mary was born without sin—was proclaimed Roman Catholic dogma in 1854.

UNION SQUARE

845



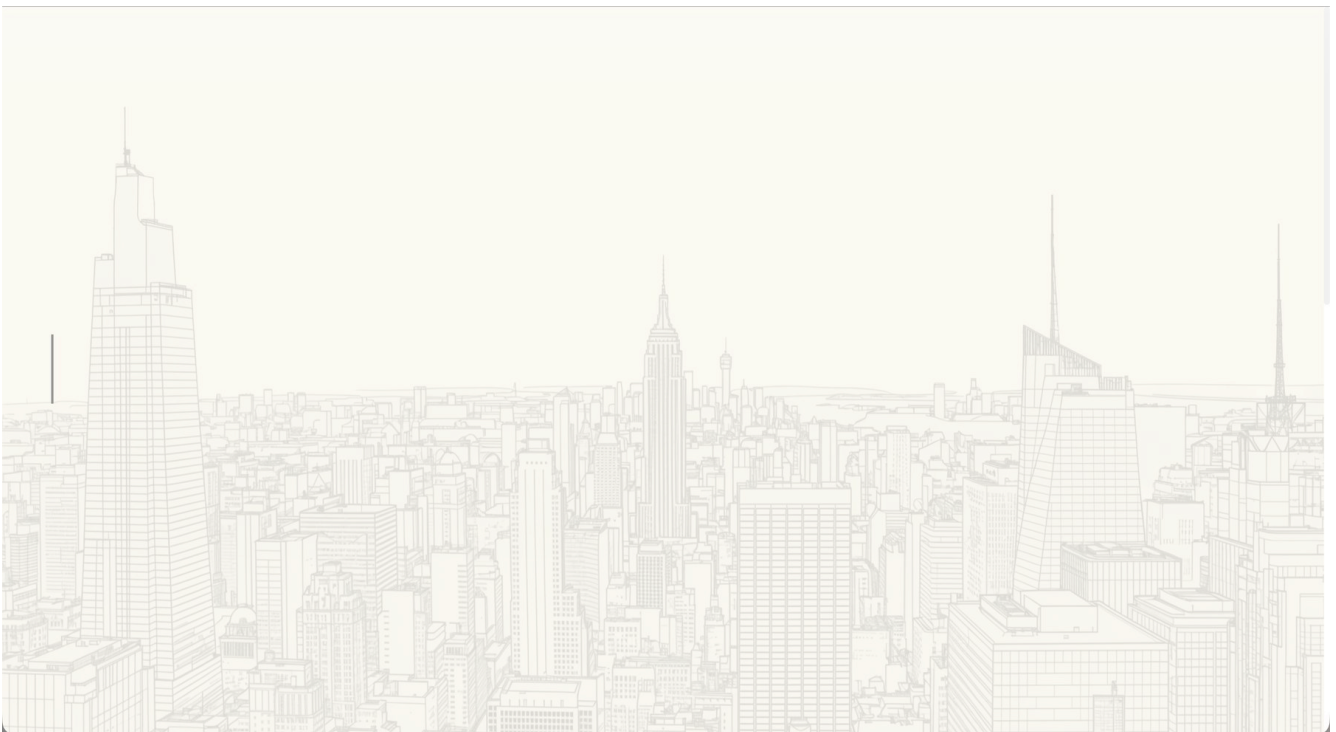
14th to 17th Sts., between Fourth Ave. and Broadway.

Union Square took its name from the fact that it was the spot where the Bowery and Bloomingdale Road (today's Broadway) came together, that is, united. The park opened in 1831, and it was soon surrounded by elegant mansions, theaters, and concert halls. From the Civil War until well into the twentieth century, workers' rallies and political protests were

often held here. The area went through a period of decline after World War II, but in the 1990s it sprang to life once again. The equestrian statue on the south side of the Square shows George Washington reclaiming New York from the British on November 25, 1783, and it stands just a few feet from where the event actually happened (Henry Kirke Brown, 1856). Other statues in the Square include one of Abraham Lincoln (Brown,

Leadon, *Broadway A History of New York in Thirteen Miles*, 2018, p. 118

Quotes drawn from this page: 45 46 47 48 49 89





The "Great Union Meeting" at Union Square, April 20, 1861.

845.1

ing the formerly tranquil square hummed with commercial activity, with once-grand mansions converted to boardinghouses, stores, and offices rented to chiropodists, coal dealers, dressmakers, milliners, hairdressers, furriers, and cloak manufacturers.

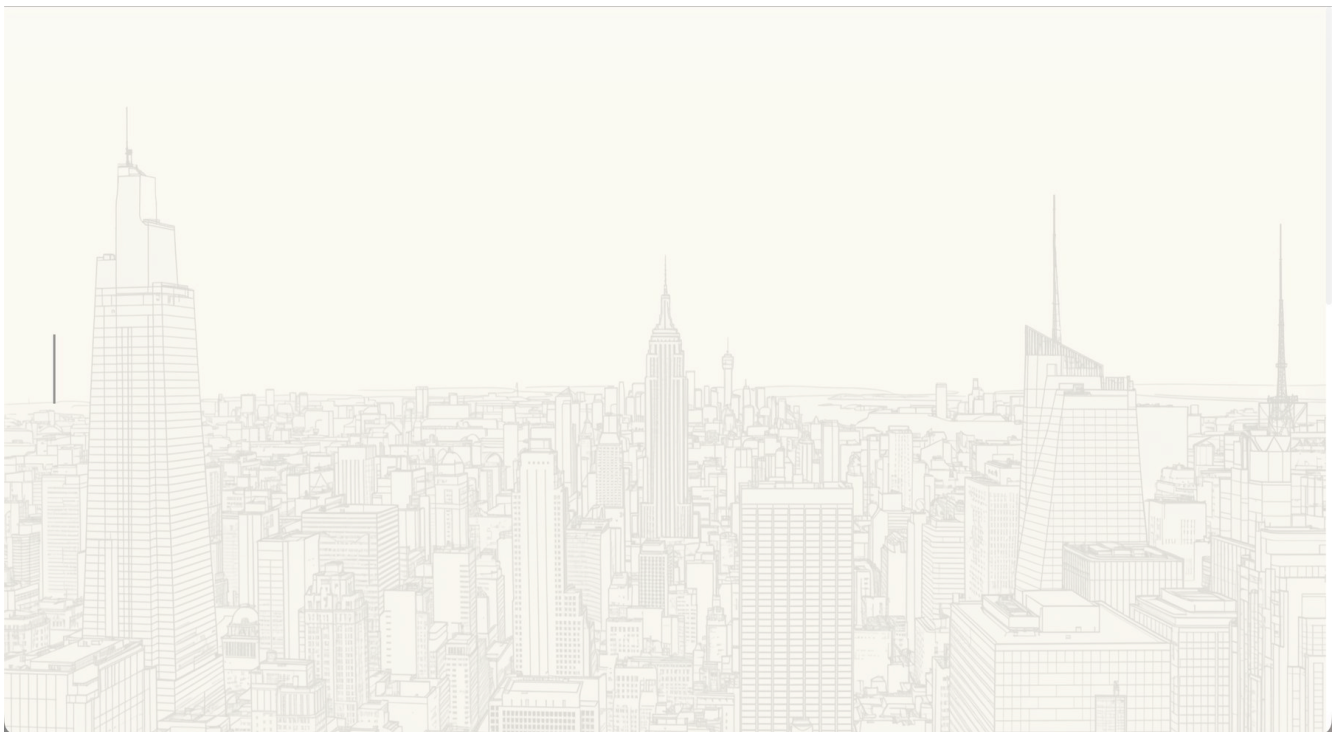
In 1872 the city hired Calvert Vaux and Frederick Law Olmsted, designers of Central Park, to remake Union Square according to a more up-to-date, picturesque aesthetic. Four years later, Olmsted was put in charge of the culminating pageant of the city's 1876 "Centennial Celebration," the most ambitious public demonstration Union Square had seen since the 1861 Great Union Meeting. Coming in the wake of several years of sectarian violence between the city's Catholics and Protestants, the Centennial Celebration was choreographed to depict New York as a thriving city at peace, where everyone, rich and poor, black and white, Protestant and Catholic, native-born and immigrant, got along famously.

immigrant, got along famously.

Just before midnight on July 3, following a torchlight parade up Broadway, its entire length decorated with flags and streamers and illuminated with gas jets, an estimated crowd of 40,000 to 50,000

Leadon, *Broadway A History of New York in Thirteen Miles*, 2018, p. 129

Quotes drawn from this page: 54 55 56 57 58 59 60



bomb intended for Ludlow mine owner John D. Rockefeller, Berkman, who had been released from prison eight years earlier, staged a "funeral" for the would-be bombers in Union Square. Speakers, including anarchists Rebecca Edelsohn and Charles Plunkett and Wobblies Carlo Tresca and Elizabeth Gurley Flynn, held forth under the watchful eyes of Chief Inspector Max F. Schmittberger and a force of 1,000 police armed with clubs.

"I want to say it's about time the working class came out frankly and openly and said 'Yes, we believe in violence,'" Edelsohn, wearing a black dress and red stockings, told the crowd. "We will use violence whenever it is necessary to use it. We are not afraid of what your kept press says; and when we are murdered and cannonaded, when you train your machine guns on us, we will retaliate with dynamite."

"[I] am for violence," Charles Plunkett shouted. "Not only defensive violence, but offensive violence. I don't believe in waiting until we are attacked . . . [They] have guns, they have cannon, they have soldiers, they have discipline, they have armies—and we have dynamite. To oppression, to exploitation, to tyranny, to jails, clubs, guns, armies and navies, there is but one reply: dynamite!"

"[While] we are approaching the Social Revolution," Berkman declared, "there will always be individuals, more intelligent, more



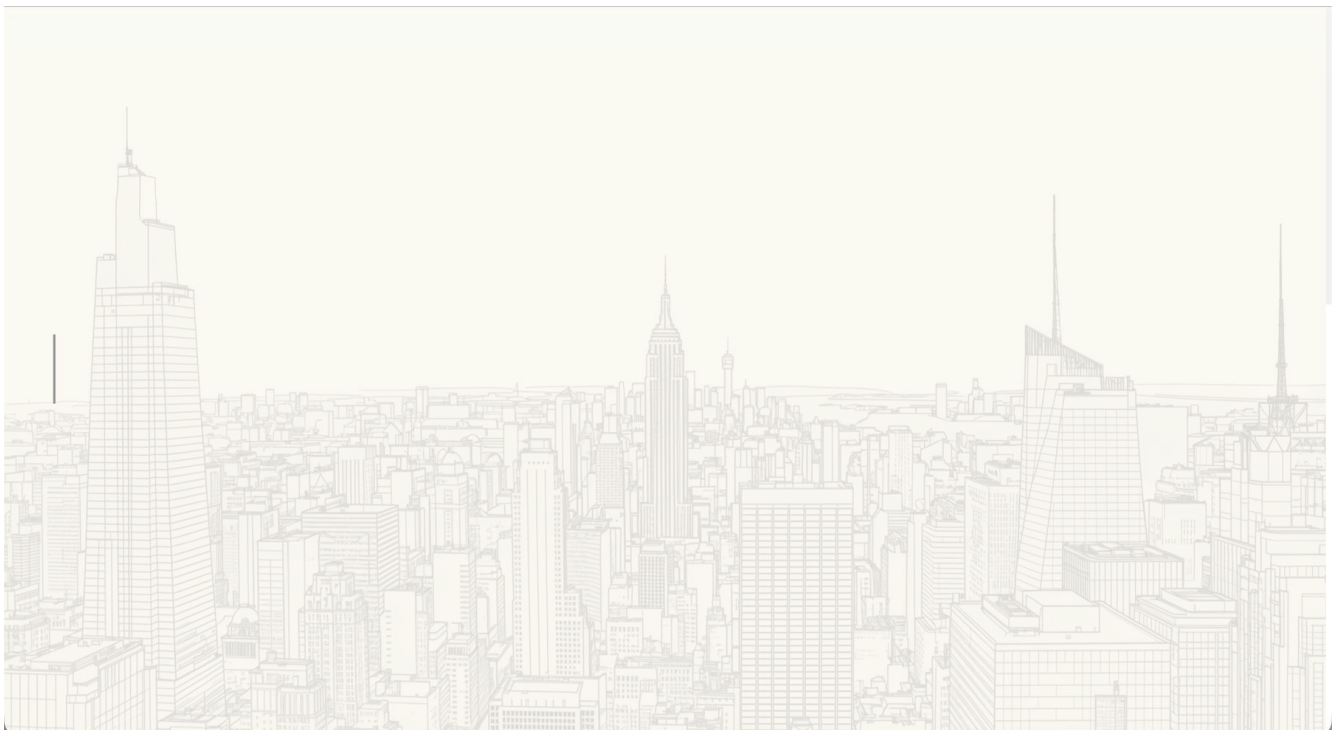


The bodies of bomber Selig Silverstein and the passerby
he killed, Union Square, March 28, 1968.

845.1

Whalen, *Mr New York*, 1955, p. 155

Quotes drawn from this page: 66 67 68 69 70 71 72



rest rooms. The crowds arriving for the meeting became so great and the congestion around the subway stations so serious that I was forced to request the Interborough Rapid Transit and the BMT to have all their northbound and southbound trains skip the stations between Grand Central and Brooklyn Bridge so that we would not have a subway panic to add to our problems.

Over 100,000 people had congregated around Union Square by noon. It was one of the largest crowds ever seen there and was the high-water mark in Red demonstrations. If the police had attempted to disperse this enormous throng there would inevitably have been a great deal of bloodshed. I had given earlier instructions to the Commanding Officer of Detectives to assign two or three detectives to "tail" each member of the Communist committee, and so it was an easy matter to locate them. I sent for the three leaders, Amter, Foster, and Minor who brought with them to our temporary headquarters a Negro sailor and a white soldier, making a committee of five, composed of "workers," soldiers and sailors, after the Bolshevik model. I told them that the meeting could go on even though it was being held illegally but that it would have to be concluded promptly at one o'clock.

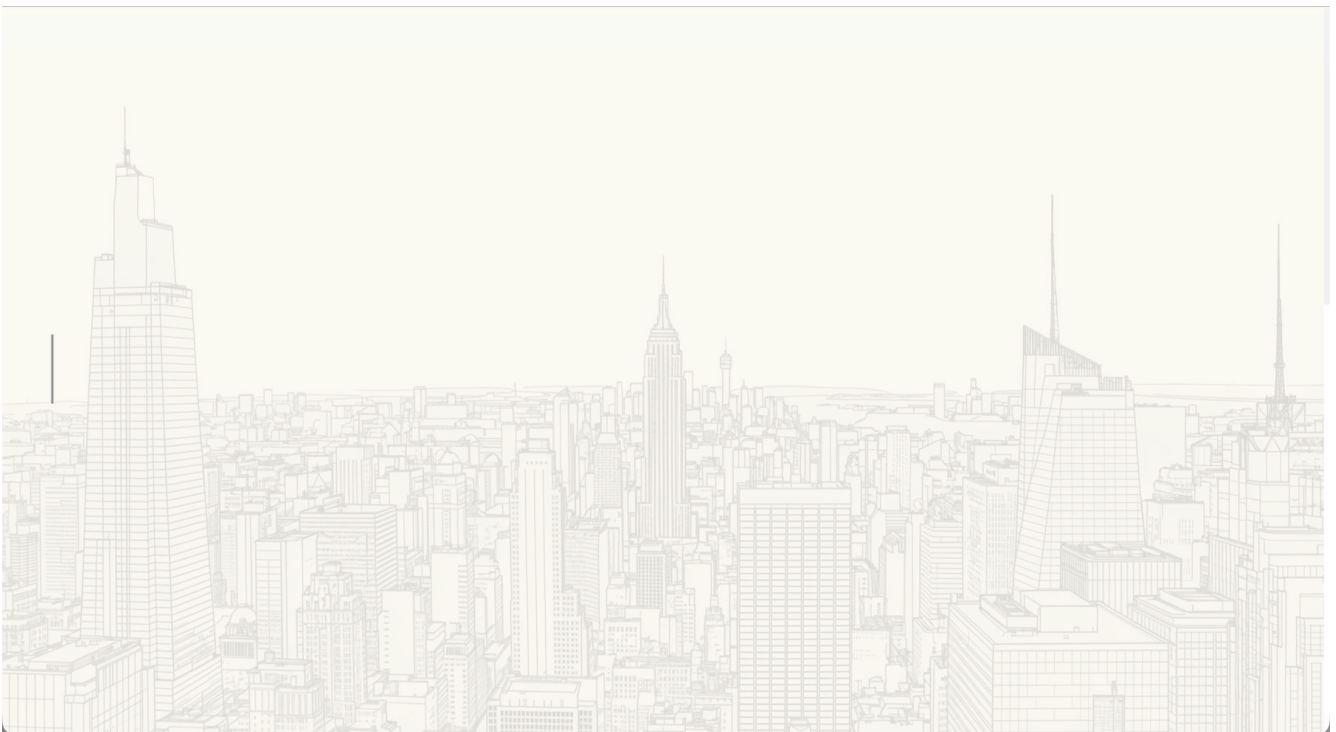
When the committee went back to the crowd it was as if by magic that six portable stands were put up for the speakers and the Soviet flag run up over the American flag. The police immediately corrected this error and ordered that the flags be reversed before any speakers could address the audience. This was done. Most of the oratory was addressed against "Whalen's Cossacks" and their brutality. One of the speakers announced that following the meeting the 100,000 people assembled in the square would march down to City Hall to protest to the Mayor and request my immediate removal as Police Commissioner. All of this I heard from our headquarters.

The hour consumed by the meeting gave me sufficient opportunity to consult the Chief Inspector and the Commanding

155

Plumb, *Notable New York The East Side*, 2006, p. 226

Quotes drawn from this page: 74 75 78 79 80 81 82





Theodore Roosevelt

Theodore Roosevelt, the twenty-sixth President of the United States, was born on October 27, 1858 on the site where this Greek revival house—a replica of the Roosevelt family's original—now stands. He lived here until 1872, when his family took him to Europe to live.

The young Roosevelt had a passionate interest in natural history and gained an impressive knowledge of the flora and fauna around him. His collection of small creatures could be found all over the mansion; houseguests at 28 East 20th Street learned to sit on sofas with caution and to check their water pitchers for snakes before pouring. The Roosevelt house, which over the years had been altered beyond all recognition, was demolished in 1916 and rebuilt to its original specifications in 1923. It's now a public museum, full of period furniture and Roosevelt memorabilia.

Artist **Andy Warhol** moved to the fifth floor of this twelve-story building in 1968. The white-walled loft space was called **The Factory** and housed studios, his office, and a screening room for his films. On June 3, 1968, **Valerie Solanas**, an occasional Factory visitor and sole member of **SCUM** (Society for Cutting Up Men), came to Warhol's office here, pulled a revolver and shot point blank at him, hitting the artist in the chest. Warhol was pronounced dead at the hospital but, miraculously, managed to survive. The crazed Solanas surrendered to the police a few hours after the shooting. She served a three-year sentence and died in 1988. Warhol lived until 1987.

2/Andy Warhol

860 Broadway at 17th Street (north-east corner).

By 1974, **Warhol** had run out of space at his Union Square studio called **The Factory** (see number 1 above) and, in August of that year, he moved across the street to this six-story brick building. The space was located on the third floor and included over 12,000 square feet of offices, storage space, and studios. Always economical, Warhol made it a condition that all visitors to The Factory during the move had to carry at least one item across the street to the new building. Warhol's studio remained here until 1982, when he began to

TOUR 3

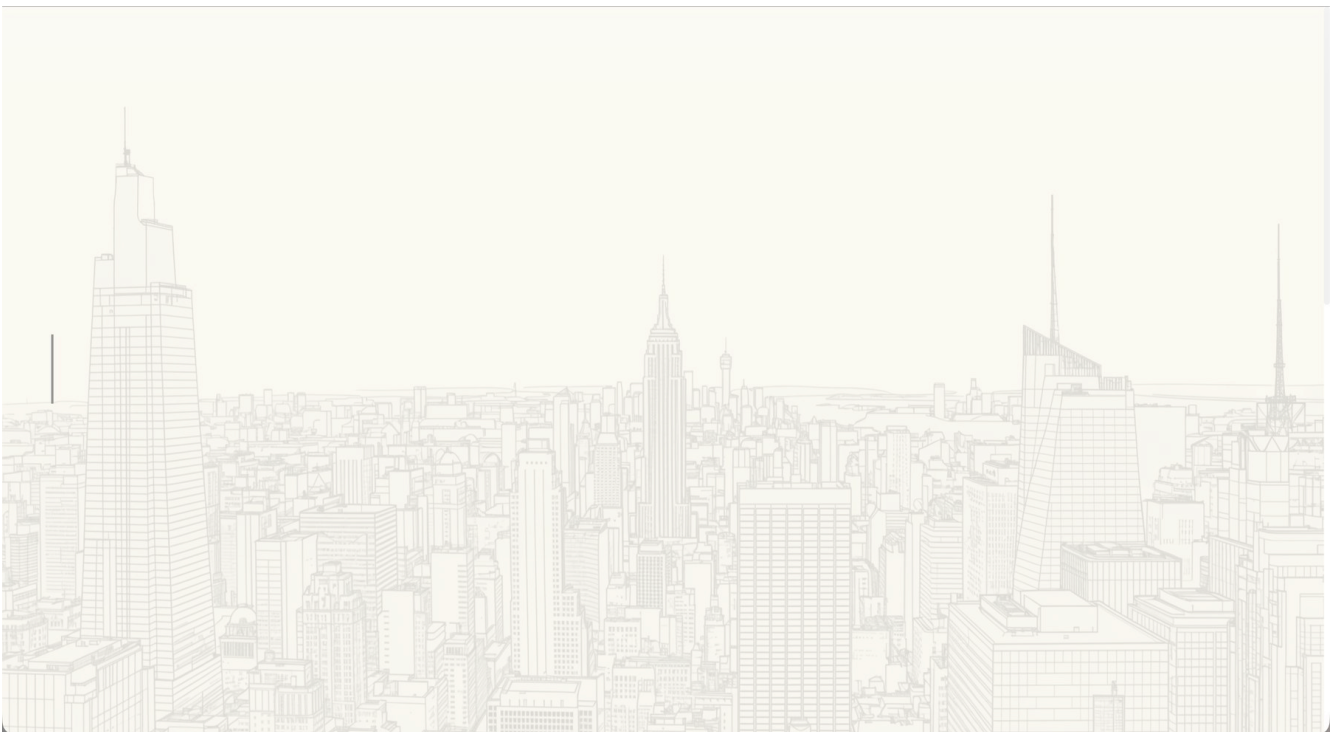
1/Andy Warhol

33 Union Square West between 16th and 17th Street.

move most of the factory's enterprises into a disused five-story Con Edison building that was a T-shaped structure with short facades on the west side of Madison Avenue between 32nd and 33rd Street. 862.1

Kiedrowski, *Andy Warhols New York*, 2011, p. 93

Quotes drawn from this page: 76 77



Warhol's 2nd Factory

1968–1973

33 Union Square West (16th St./17th St.)

By December 1967, there were plans to move Warhol's Factory to an office building on Union Square West. The lease on the 47th Street space had been lost due to a developer's plan to erect 1 Dag Hammerskjold Plaza on the corner of Second Avenue and 47th Street. The eleven-story Decker Building on Union Square was designed by John Edelman, an architect known to have anarchist sympathies, for the Decker Piano Co. The 1893 structure, created in a Moorish style, features sunflowers, ogee arches, and arabesques on the façade. The minaret on top was removed many years ago.

1321

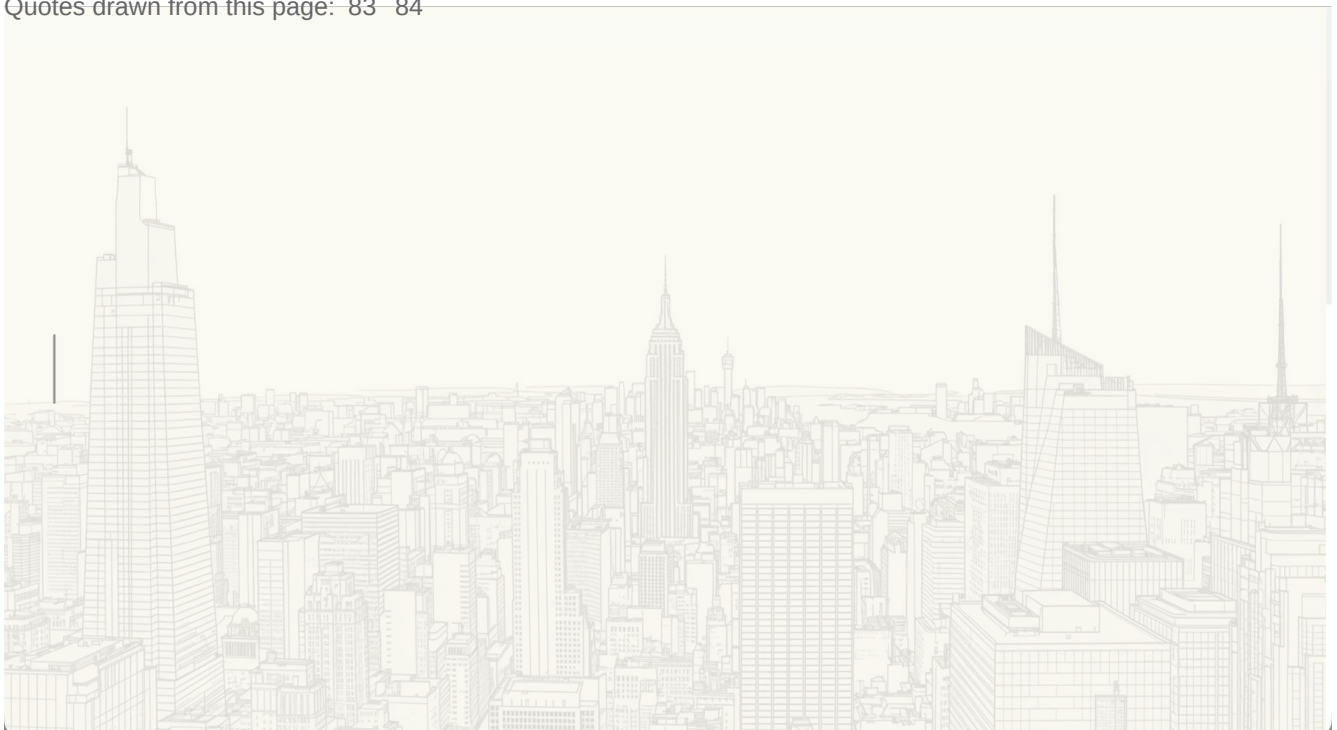
The new sixth-floor space was bright, painted white in the front with a screening room painted dark brown in the back, with hardwood floors and other wood molding throughout. It was certainly nothing like the old space, which had tired concrete floors, crumbling silver walls, and dilapidated furniture. Nonetheless, the new space was still called the Factory (and sometimes, the White Factory). A stuffed Great Dane (which Warhol hinted had belonged to Cecil B. DeMille—though the staff could never match it to any photos of DeMille's

dogs) stood next to the entrance as their lone security measure. The sixth floor has one of two front exterior balconies.

Initially, a painting space wasn't required due to Warhol's retirement from painting in May 1965; film projects were now the focus of his business. He had formed Andy Warhol Films, Inc., and with the help of Paul Morrissey, began to create a business he hoped might generate interest in Hollywood. The first project was a western later named *Lonesome Cowboys*, filmed in Old Tucson, Arizona, on a dude ranch where John Wayne had made Hollywood westerns. One day the

Kiedrowski, *Andy Warhols New York*, 2011, p. 97

Quotes drawn from this page: 83–84



moved down the street in September 1974. The Decker Building has since been turned into condominiums.

62

Columbus Hospital (Cabriní Medical Center)

1968

900

227 East 19th Street (Second Ave./Third Ave.)



On June 3, 1968, a radical feminist and Factory hanger-on named Valerie Solanas shot Andy Warhol. Warhol was taken to Columbus Hospital, and pronounced clinically dead. He was revived after doctors massaged his heart and worked for hours, removing pieces of damaged organs and cleaning the bullet paths made by Solanas's gun. After a nearly two-month stay, Warhol was released and ordered to wear a corset for the rest of his life to keep his scarred chest from reopening. Richard Avedon recorded the marks made by the stitches in a well-known photo. Warhol announced to friends that the surgery scars made him look like a Dior dress.

Candy Darling was later hospitalized here while she received treatment for cancer and eventually died here in 1974. In 1988, after the hospital became Cabriní Medical Center, Jean-Michel Basquiat was brought here, having overdosed on heroin. He was pronounced DOA (dead on arrival). The hospital has now closed.

63

3rd Factory aka The Office

1974–1984

860 Broadway (17th St.)

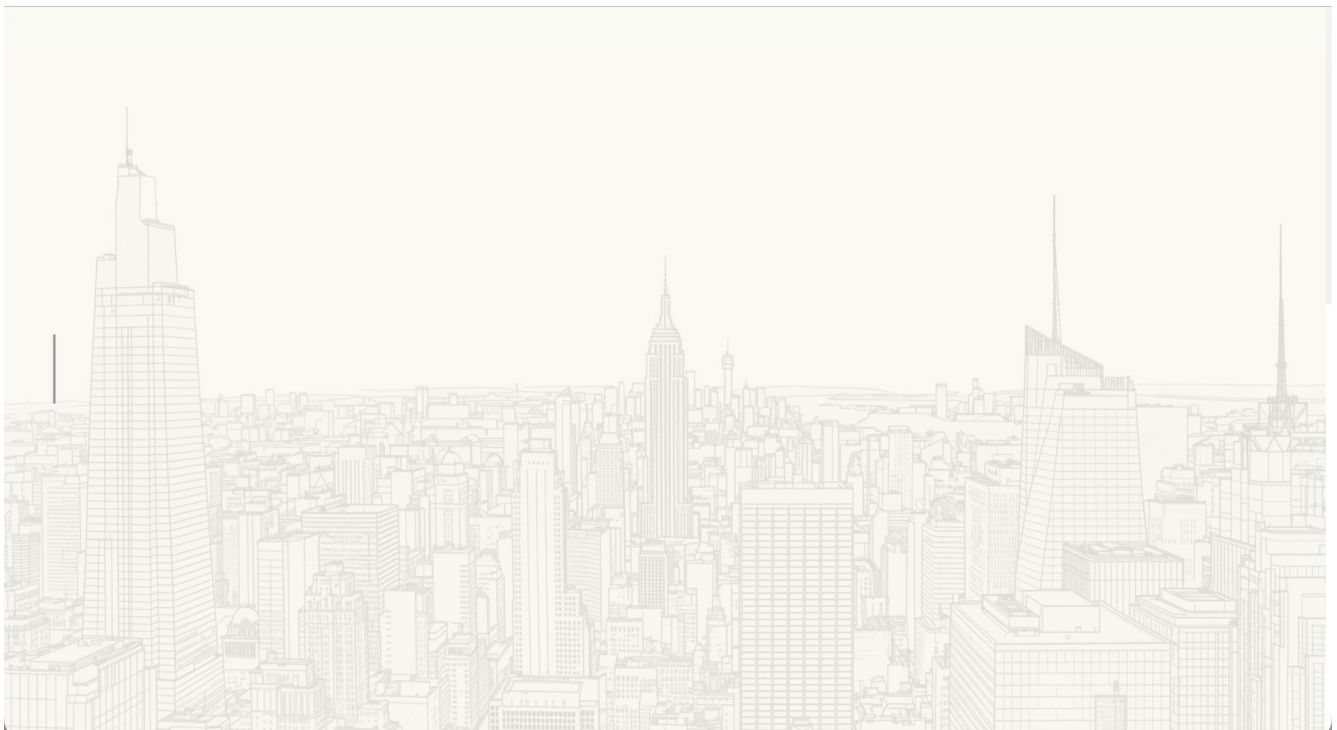
846.2



The third floor of this building, once the offices of S&H Green Stamps in the twenties, was the setting for Warhol's third Factory from 1974–1984. Here, Andy Warhol Enterprises, initially set up in 1957 for tax purposes, took off. The new Union Square space was just

Plumb, *Notable New York The East Side*, 2006, p. 231

Quotes drawn from this page: 85 86 87 88



vented the inaccurate story that **Washington Irving** had lived here (see the plaque on the north wall of the building).

10/Theodore Dreiser

201 Park Avenue South at 17th Street (northeast corner).

In January 1925, **Theodore Dreiser** rented a small office in the **Guardian Life Insurance Building** across from Union Square while he worked on the completion of his novel *An American Tragedy*. During this period, Dreiser was living in Brooklyn with his companion, **Helen Richardson** and he utilized her, in addition to two other women, to assist him in the typing and editing of the lengthy book. Also residing in the Guardian building was an attorney friend of the author who advised him on the legal aspects of his story based on a real event involving a sensational murder trial. The book was published at the end of 1925 and became a great critical and popular success. After years of financial struggle, Dreiser became rich.

11/Arshile Gorky

36 Union Square East at 16th Street (northeast corner).

Painter **Arshile Gorky** worked on his art in a studio on this site from 1929 until his death in 1948. It was in a three-story building with an

Federal Arts Project and also supported himself by teaching. He was one of the few artists of that period with a studio separate from his residence and Gorky treated his working space here as a sacred area—he scrubbed the floor weekly, stocked it with the best materials, and hung life-size photographs of his favorite masters on the wall. Gorky, an early abstract painter who had a deep influence on younger artists, never received the critical acclaim that he deserved during his lifetime. He ran into a streak of bad luck in his last years—he broke his neck in a car crash and also developed rectal cancer. Gorky committed suicide by hanging in Connecticut on July 21, 1948 at the age of forty-eight.

12/Charles Dickens

37 Irving Place at 16th Street (northwest corner).

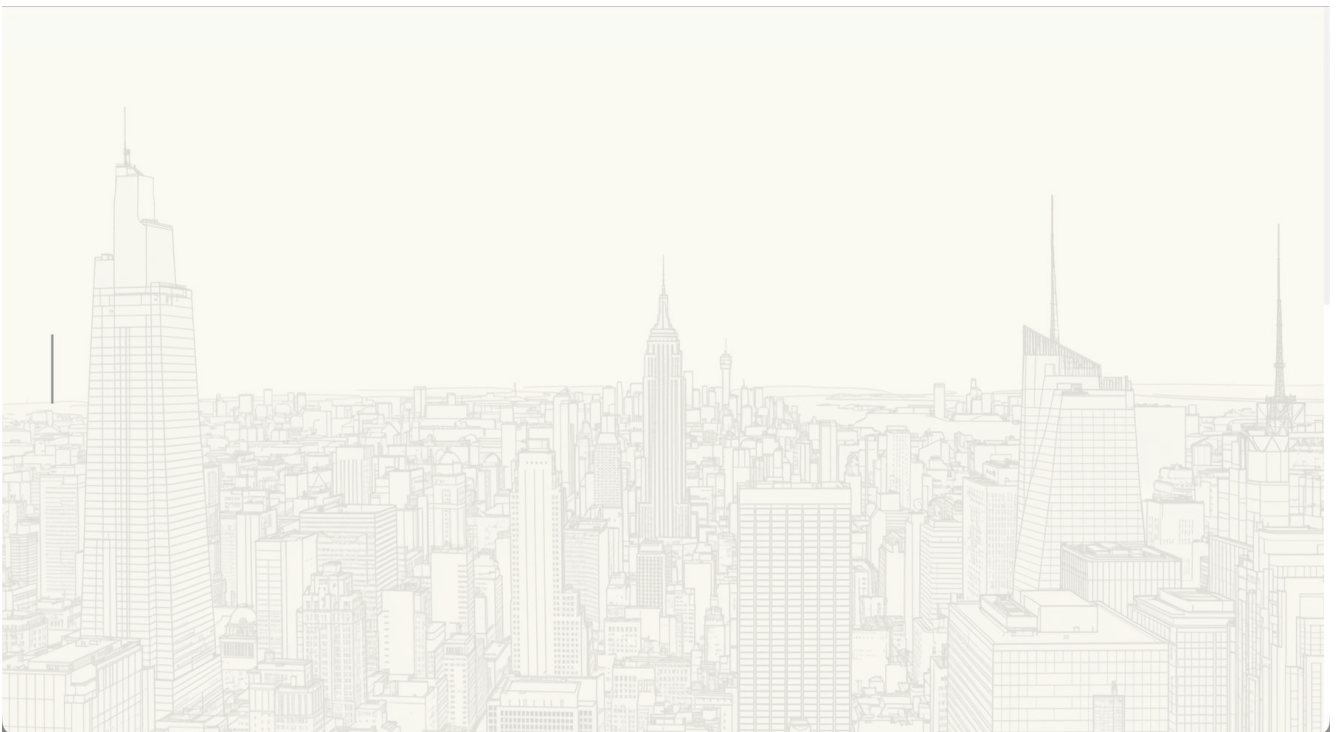
Charles Dickens made his second visit to America in 1867. He arrived in Boston in November to begin a long series of scheduled readings and, by early December, he was in New York. While he was here, he lived in the **Westminster Hotel** where this municipal government building now stands. Dickens found the hotel almost faultless, offering excellent food and service and providing him with a quiet, private apartment with separate access to the street. Even in the bitterly cold wea-

entrance on the north side of 16th Street. Gorky was an Armenian born in Turkey who came to New York in 1925. He was poor all of his life; during the 1930s, like many struggling artists, he enlisted in the WPA's

ther, he went out sightseeing, visiting the central police station at three a.m. one morning and taking a long sleigh ride in the country on another. When a fire broke out in the hotel, he enjoyed the spectacle of people turn-

Wolfe, *New York 15 Walking Tours*, 2003, p. 252

Quotes drawn from this page: 90



example of a Romanesque Revival-style commercial building. Faced with gray granite, limestone, and brick and decorated with terra cotta, the building, considered a skyscraper when built, exemplifies the transition between masonry and later steel framework construction. Note the multiwindow cornice.

No. 5-9, the **Spingler Building**, faced with brown brick and ornate terra cotta, dates from the late 1890s and displays typical Romanesque Revival features. In the Gilded Age, many luxury establishments opened on the Square, particularly along the west side. **Tiffany's** famed jewelry establishment moved up from lower Broadway in 1870 and opened an elegant showroom. **Brentano's** soon followed, one block north, calling itself "New York's Literary Emporium" and attracting a host of loyal readers. It is interesting to note that Agosto Brentano, who came to America as a poor cripple from Sicily, eked out a living selling newspapers and periodicals, and ultimately became the most famous book dealer in the country.

The 1960s modern "skin" of No. 11-15, the main office of the **Amalgamated Bank of New York**, hides a cast-iron structure within. The building, which was designed in 1869 by John Kellum, had housed the showrooms and silversmith operations of Charles Tiffany, until he moved uptown in 1906. The bank opened on the site in 1923 under the auspices of the Amalgamated Clothing Workers Union and is reputed to be the only one in the United States owned entirely by a union. No. 25, the Carlyle Court, formerly an apartment building, is one of New York University's numerous far-flung dormitories.

No. 31, the **former Bank of the Metropolis** (Bruce Price, 1902), is a fine example of the architect's favored Renaissance Revival style. Although the building's front features polished marble columns, the entire structure is, in effect, columnar or tripartite in form, with a base, shaft, and capital represented by its three stone sections. The bank, founded in 1871, served local businesses until 1918, when it merged with the Bank of the Manhattan Company (now J. P. Morgan Chase). A restaurant occupies the main floor with residences above.

No. 33, originally the Decker Building, now the **Union Building** (Alfred Zucker, with John Edelman, 1892), displays the almost limitless possibilities of terra-cotta adornment, in this case with unusual Moorish Revival motifs. Built for the Decker Piano Company, its highly ornate façade was a singular attraction. Edelman, who was Zucker's designer, was influenced by his friend and teacher, Chicago architect Louis Sullivan, and the building exhibits many obvious Sullivanian touches. In the early 1990s, the building was renovated for condominiums by Joseph Pell Lombardi & Associates. 845.1

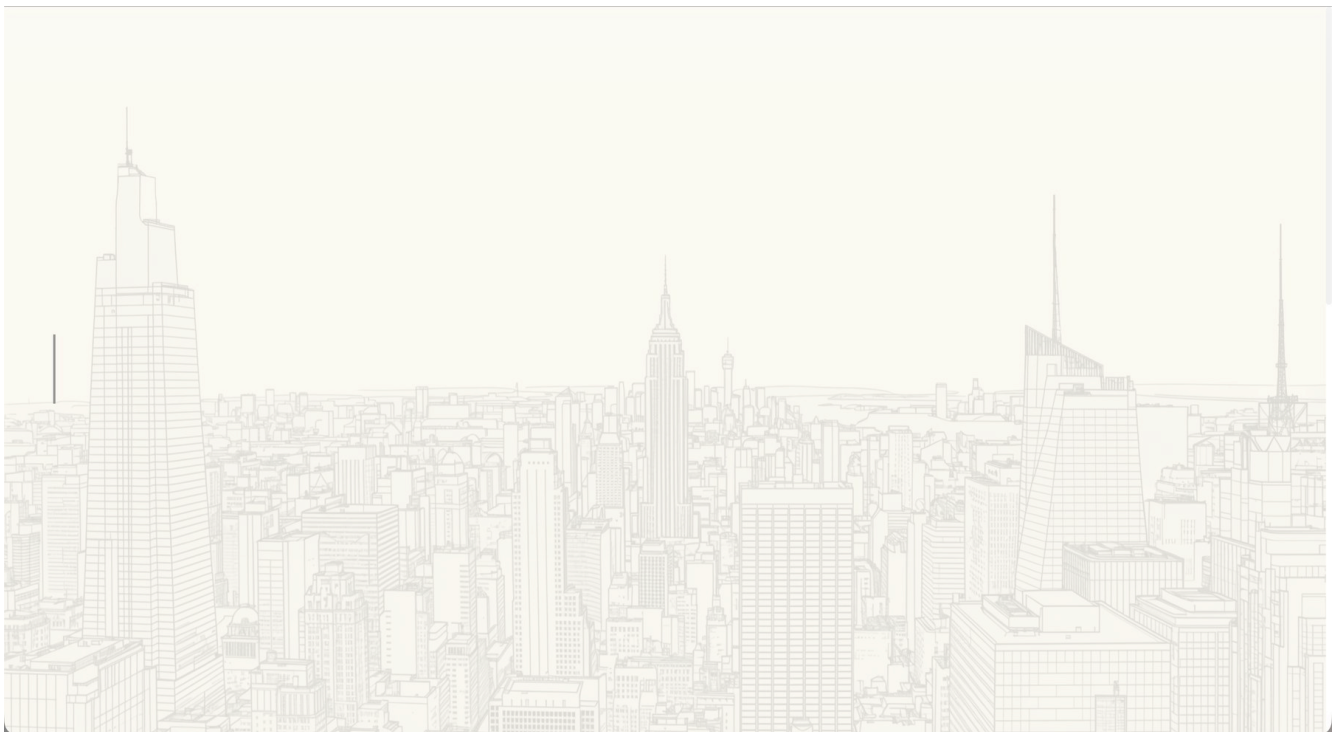
On the west side of the park stood a bronze **fountain sculpture group** on a tall pedestal, depicting a woman holding a baby in one arm and helping a child hold a water pitcher in the other, by German sculptor Adolf Donndorf and presented to the city in 1881. The large pedestal was festooned with lions' heads

and a variety of animals, insects, and lizards. (Temporarily removed during park renovation.)

Enter the park, walk toward the center, and turn left to the heroic bronze **Statue of Abraham Lincoln** (Henry Kirke Brown, 1868). The statue was funded by popular subscription and shows the Great Emancipator in a pose as if address-

King, *King's Handbook of New York City*, 1892, p. 689

Quotes drawn from this page: 91 92



virtue of the banking privilege included in its charter, the company won such a reputation for financial strength and solidity that the founders of the Dry-Dock Savings Bank thought it well to perpetuate the title in association with a financial institution.

The Bank of the Metropolis is a flourishing outgrowth of the movement of business to the up-town section of New York. Union Square, where its banking house is established, was thirty years ago a fashionable residence-district. To-day it is surrounded by some of the largest retail business houses in New York, and important manufacturing and wholesale industries are plentiful in the neighborhood. The magnitude of these interests is attested by the success of this prosperous institution, the business of which is derived from their requirements, and which is conducted in a manner to attract the custom and support of the dry-goods, furniture, jewelry, and other classes of merchants whose places of business are in the vicinity. The bank was organized in 1871, and commenced operations in June of that year. The first President was W. A. Kissam (who died in the same year), and the original place of business was 31 Union Square. A removal to 17 Union Square followed six years later, and in 1888 the bank took the more commodious quarters at 29 Union Square, which it now occupies. Robert Schell, the President, who has held the position steadily for twenty years, was formerly a well-known jewelry merchant in Maiden Lane. William B. Isham, the Vice-President (since 1885), was promi-

nent in the leather trade; and the Cashier, Theodore Rogers, has occupied the same position since the formation of the bank. The Board of Directors is a remarkably strong body, comprising representatives of houses which are known not only in New York but throughout the United States. They are Charles L. Tiffany, of Tiffany & Company; Hon. Samuel Sloan, President of the Delaware, Lackawanna & Western Railroad; Robert Schell, the President; Joseph Park, of Park & Tilford; William Steinway, of Steinway & Sons; William B. Isham, capitalist; W. D. Sloane, of W. & J. Sloane; and Hicks Arnold, of Arnold, Constable & Company. The bank



BANK OF THE METROPOLIS, 29 UNION SQUARE, WEST, SOUTHWEST CORNER OF 16TH STREET.

has a deposit line of nearly \$7,000,000; and a surplus of \$700,000 has been accumulated on the capital of \$300,000. The shares of the Bank of the Metropolis have a market value of over \$400 each.

An institution of such solidity and enterprise, and with such widely and favorably known officers and directors, is of great benefit to business in the up-town district.

AIA, *AIA Guide to New York City Edition 3*, 1988, p. 185

Quotes drawn from this page: 93



Union Square later became the center of the political left: here, in August 1927, protestors awaited news of the execution of **Sacco and Vanzetti**. **May Day**, the annual celebration of **socialism**, brought a million to this mecca where the **Daily Worker** and many other radical publications and organizations abounded.

[W 1a.] **Union Square Park**, E. 14th to E. 17th Sts., Union Sq. W. to Union Sq. E. Laid out, 1830. Opened to public, 1839. Rebuilt, 1986. Bronson Binger, architect; Hui Mei Grove, landscape architect; N.Y.C. Department of Parks & Recreation, Capital Projects Division. **Newsstand**, Union Sq. E. opp. E. 15th St. 1986. Kuo Ming Tsu.



The park's raised posture is a latter-day event, allowing the subway to snake through its underworld: the original street-level park with romantically curving pathways was then totally rebuilt as a more formal public place. In those early subway times crowds gathered around their favorite debater to heckle, support, or berate him or her. This was **New York's Speakers' Corner**; it became a sacred precinct for soapbox orators and other agitators after police excesses in repressing unemployment rallies in the 1930s.

Drug traffickers in the 1960s and 1970s controlled the scene, but the 1986 renovation removed the perimeter screens of green, making all activities within visible and returning the park to a civilized population. (The druggies, of course, merely emigrated to new turf).

The renovation, designed by the Parks Department's own staff, is the best in anyone's memory: bold replanning of the entry areas, generous stone detailing, railings in scale (for once!) with a public place (using bulbous malleable iron fittings at joints), punctuated with built-up steel and glass kiosks over the subway entrances and for the newsstand, and lighted with ornate multiglobed lamps. Why not the same verve and skill to enhance Madison and Bryant Parks, and Greeley and Herald Squares!

The park abounds in sculpture: *Washington* (Henry Kirke Brown, sculptor), a copy of Houdon's original horseback eulogy, arrived in 1856. **Brown** also contributed *Lincoln* in 1866. In 1876 **Bartholdi**, sculptor of the **Statue of Liberty**, left *Lafayette* as a token of Franco-American relations at a point early in his unceasing campaign to raise funds for the base of *Liberty*. The flagpole base is by **Anthony de Francisci**, sculptor.

[W 1b.] **Union Square farmers' market**, along W. 17th St. bet. Broadway and Park Ave. S. at the N edge of Union Sq. Gateways, 1987, Roy Strickland and Carson & Stillman.

The ephemeral Green Market, an idea of architect-planner **Barry Benepe**, is the serious architecture of cheese, tomatoes, legumes, and

other edibles. The structures are confined to two rather pretentious but sad metallic gateways at the northwest and northeast corners.

[W 2.] Zeckendorf Towers (mixed use), 1 Irving Place, bet. W. 14th and W. 15th Sts. to Union Sq. E. 1987. Davis, Brody & Assocs.

Four finials, each with an illuminated, levitating, pyramidal yaf-mulka, crown a massive commercial bottom: each finial is a separate apartment tower. This is a colossal project that largely blocks the once familiar view of Con Edison's clock tower for users of the park.

From 1921 until they were demolished in 1985 this was the site of a clutch of small 19th-century buildings that were the home of **S. Klein's on the Square**, the original discount department store. Above them stood a Times Square-scale neon sign that advertised Klein's name to hordes of women shoppers. The modest budget was served there not only with bargains but also **occasional high style** . . . the latter for those stalwarts with energy and sharp eyes who combed the sea of clothes racks with vigor. (Klein's closed in August, 1975.)

At the southeast corner of 15th Street and Fourth Avenue, later to be included in Sam Klein's empire, stood the original Union Square Hotel. The **single-tax economist** Henry George died here on October 29, 1897. George sought simplification of the maze of taxes that were then only in their infancy. His mind would have boggled at today's **Byzantium** imposed by federal, state, city, and other taxes.

Chelsea/Four Squares: see map pp. 170–171 185

Ferrara, *A Guide to Gangsters*, 2009, p. 181

Quotes drawn from this page: 94 95



East Houston Street to East Fourteenth Street: A Radical New Direction

his clothing and went to a friend's bar at 162 East Fourth Street. At the bar, Charles ordered two glasses of seltzer and threw \$100 on the bar as he left, stating, "Here, keep this to bury me with."

Charles was captured a short time later because his eldest daughter, sensing trouble, had not gone out to play with the other children. She witnessed the terrible murder by peeking through the keyhole. As a result, she reported the incident to neighbors and police.

East Fourteenth Street

62 East Fourteenth Street

By 1920, former gang leader Monk Eastman was trying to lead a life along the straight and narrow. He was now a decorated war hero, after fighting for the U.S. Army in Europe during World War I, but he couldn't catch a break on the streets. So he got involved with a crooked Prohibition agent, who on December 26 of that year shot and killed Eastman in a drunken dispute on the sidewalk outside this address.

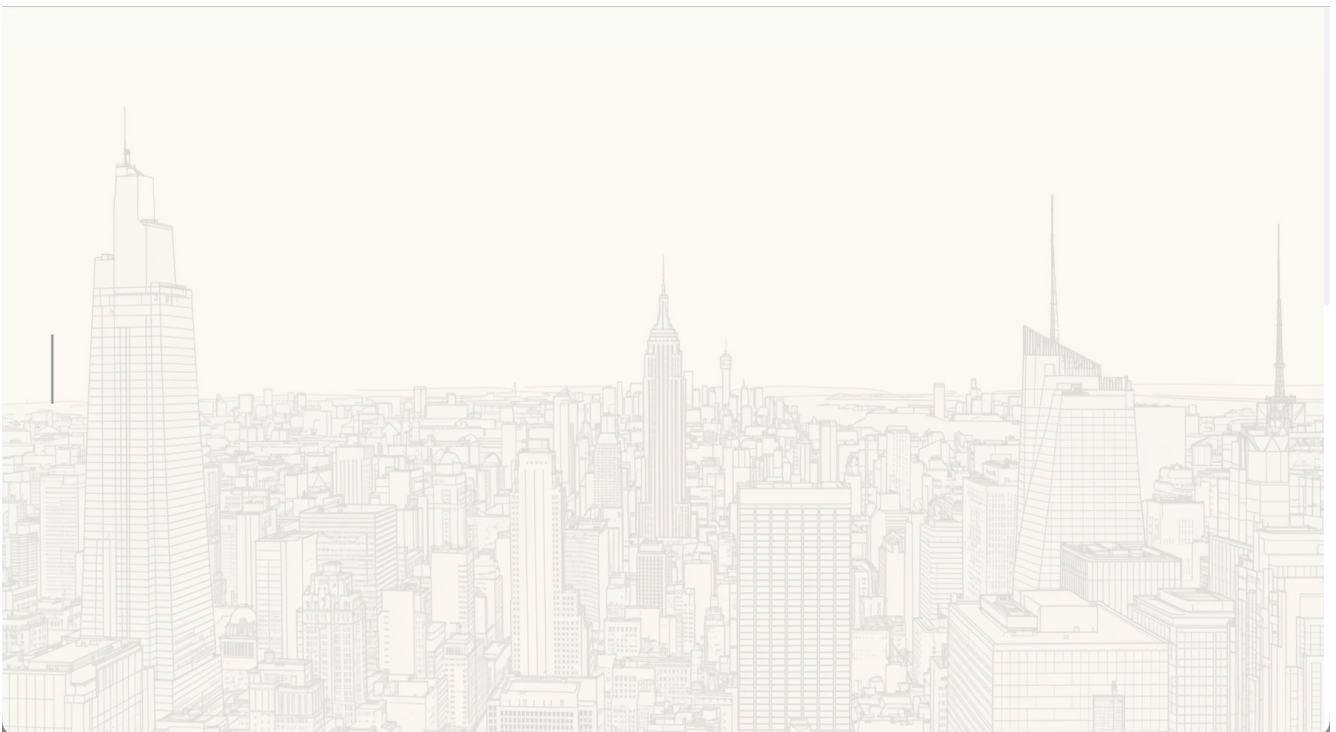
106 East Fourteenth Street

This corner was the site of Huber's Dime Museum in the late nineteenth century. The museum featured sideshow performers and magic shows. Harry Houdini was showcased here, as well as Dr. Henry S. Tanner, who survived a forty-day public fast at the museum in 1880. The Great Harry Houdini grew up in New York City after his family moved here from Wisconsin (by

way of Hungary). A set of Houdini's handcuffs can be viewed at McSorley's Pub (15 East Seventh Street), New York City's oldest continuously run alehouse.

Wilson, *New York in Literature*, 1947, p. 128

Quotes drawn from this page: 96 97



That sturdy descendant of the Knickerbockers, Gulian C. Verplanck, died at 12 East Sixteenth Street, and adjoining the College of St. Francis Xavier, less than a block distant, is the brownstone house which was the home of Bryant in the "white winter of his age." Again at 115 East Sixteenth Street Howells lodged for a time in 1900 and 1901. "I see a great deal of Mark Twain nowadays," he wrote his sister from this address, "and we have good times denouncing everything. We are old fellows, and it is pleasant to find the world so much worse than it was when we were young." And William S. Rainsford's home was at 209 East Sixteenth Street in the years when he was finding zest and profit in the labors later recorded in the *Story of a Varied Life*. George E. Woodberry, when a professor at Columbia, had bachelor apartments at 5 East Seventeenth Street. This was on the morrow of the writing and publication of the life of Poe for which he is now best remembered, and which summed up that poet's shortcomings with a severity still disputed by students of a troubled career. A three-story structure of red brick at 66 East Seventeenth Street was for a number of years the home of Edgar, nephew of Washington Irving, and an occasional sojourn of the gentle humorist when in old age he came from Sunnyside for a few days' visit to the city; and the last home of Jeannette L. Gilder, long editor of the *Critic* and an arresting, if some times amusing, figure in the literary life of the town a generation ago, was at 100 East Seventeenth Street.

At 23 Irving Place in the middle years of the last century dwelt Isaac C. Pray, brother of the gifted Malvina Pray and himself an author, actor and playwright of parts, who there wrote a biography of the elder Bennett, founder of the *Herald*, and welcomed Charles Dickens as friend and guest when in 1842 the latter visited America for the first time. Eleven numbers northward on the same side of Irving Place, still stands an old-fashioned house which was the last home of Caroline Matilda Kirkland, whose sketches of Western life, published under the pen name of Mary Clevers, gave her a secure if modest place in the literary circles of her period. At 57 Irving Place was long the home of William Conant Church, editor of the *Army and Navy Journal*, who there wrote his life of Ericsson and other books. Two doors removed on the same side of the way William Sidney

Porter had his lodgings during his most productive years as an author, finding in the neighborhood the background for some of his most diverting tales.

